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PORTABLE ELECTRONIC DEVICE CASE ACCESSORIES AND RELATED SYSTEMS AND METHODS

Abstract

Case accessories for portable electronic devices are disclosed. In some embodiments, a case accessory may include a base configured to sit on a working surface, a support coupled to the base and configured to support a portable electronic device in an elevated position, a rotational mechanism coupled to the support configured to allow the holder to rotate in one or more directions relative to the support, and a holder coupled to the rotational mechanism and configured to secure the portable electronic device.

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Background/Summary

RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/656,533, filed Mar. 25, 2022, and entitled PORTABLE ELECTRONIC DEVICE CASE ACCESSORIES AND RELATED SYSTEMS AND METHODS, which is continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/183,443, filed Nov. 7, 2018, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,360,513, issued Jun. 14, 2022 and entitled “PORTABLE ELECTRONIC DEVICE CASE ACCESSORIES AND RELATED SYSTEMS AND METHODS” which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 13/601,799, filed Aug. 31, 2012, now U.S. Pat. No. 10,139,861, issued Nov. 27, 2018 and entitled “PORTABLE ELECTRONIC DEVICE CASE ACCESSORIES AND RELATED SYSTEMS AND METHODS” which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 13/155,266, filed Jun. 7, 2011, now U.S. Pat. No. 9,170,611, issued Oct. 27, 2015 and entitled “PORTABLE ELECTRONIC DEVICE CASE ACCESSORIES AND RELATED SYSTEMS AND METHODS” which in turn claims priority to U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 61/352,286, filed Jun. 7, 2010, and entitled “ELECTRONIC READER CASES AND RELATED SYSTEMS AND METHODS,” U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 61/368,047, filed Jul. 27, 2010, and entitled “HOLDER FOR AN ELECTRONIC DEVICE,” and U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 61/421,431, filed Dec. 9, 2010, and entitled “ROTATABLE CASE FOR PORTABLE ELECTRONIC DEVICE,” all of which are herein incorporated by reference in their entireties.

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] The present disclosure relates generally to portable electronic devices and, more specifically, to case accessories for portable electronic devices.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0003] The written disclosure herein describes illustrative embodiments that are non-limiting and non-exhaustive. Reference is made to certain of such illustrative embodiments that are depicted in the figures, in which:

[0004] FIG. 1 illustrates a case for a portable electronic device oriented in a portrait viewing mode consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0005] FIG. 2 illustrates a top perspective view of the case illustrated in FIG. 1 consistent with

embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0006] FIG. **3** illustrates a rear elevation view of the case illustrated in FIG. **1** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0007] FIG. **4** illustrates a rear elevation view of the case illustrated in FIG. **1** wherein the case is oriented in a landscape viewing mode consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0008] FIG. **5** illustrates another case for a portable electronic device configured in an open position and oriented in a portrait viewing mode consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0009] FIG. **6** illustrates a top perspective view of the case illustrated in FIG. **5** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0010] FIG. **7** illustrates a rear elevation view of the case illustrated in FIG. **5** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0011] FIG. **8** illustrates a rear elevation view of the case illustrated in FIG. **5** configured in an open position and oriented in a landscape viewing mode consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0012] FIG. **9** illustrates a top perspective view of the case illustrated in FIG. **5** configured in a closed position consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0013] FIG. **10** illustrates a side elevation view of the case illustrated in FIG. **5** configured in a closed position consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0014] FIG. **11** illustrates another case for a portable electronic device oriented in a portrait viewing mode consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0015] FIG. **12** illustrates a top perspective view of the case illustrated in FIG. **11** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0016] FIG. **13** illustrates another case for a portable electronic device oriented in a portrait viewing mode consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0017] FIG. **14** illustrates a perspective view of the case illustrated in FIG. **13** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0018] FIG. **15** illustrates another case for a portable electronic device configured in an open position consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0019] FIG. **16** illustrates an isometric view of a portion of the case illustrated in FIG. **15** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0020] FIG. **17** illustrates a rotatable case for a portable electronic device configured in an open position consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0021] FIG. **18** illustrates another case for a portable electronic device configured in an open position and oriented in a portrait viewing mode consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0022] FIG. **19** illustrates a top perspective view of the case illustrated in FIG. **18** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0023] FIG. **20** illustrates a rear elevation view of the case illustrated in FIG. **18** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0024] FIG. **21** illustrates a rear elevation view of the case illustrated in FIG. **18** configured in an open position and oriented in a landscape viewing mode consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0025] FIG. **22** illustrates a rotatable case in a landscape orientation consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0026] FIG. **23** illustrates a rotatable case for a portable electronic device rotated into a portrait orientation consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0027] FIG. **24** illustrates a rotatable case in a closed position securing a portable electronic device consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0028] FIG. **25** illustrates a rotatable case securing a portable electronic device in a landscape

orientation and a first opened position consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0029] FIG. **26** illustrates a rotatable case supporting a portable electronic device at an angle in a landscape orientation and in a second opened position consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0030] FIG. **27** illustrates a portable electronic device secured by a rotatable case including a pivot flap configured to allow the portable electronic device to be pivoted to a desired angle of inclination consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0031] FIG. **28** illustrates a portable electronic device secured by a rotatable case including a grommet configured to allow the portable electronic device to be rotated from a portrait orientation to a landscape orientation and vice versa consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0032] FIG. **29** illustrates a rear view of a rotatable case securing a portable electronic device in a portrait orientation consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0033] FIG. **30** illustrates an interaction between a support panel of a rotatable case and a securing panel via a grommet consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0034] FIG. **31** illustrates a securing panel of a rotatable case and a first portion of a grommet consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0035] FIG. **32** illustrates a support panel of a rotatable case including a pivot flap and a grommet consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0036] FIG. **33** illustrates a rotatable case integrated into a larger case consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0037] FIG. **34** illustrates a multi-pivot stand for a portable electronic device including a base, a vertical support, and a case configured in a landscape orientation consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0038] FIG. **35** illustrates a multi-pivot stand for a portable electronic device including a data dock consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0039] FIG. **36** illustrates a multi-pivot stand securing a portable electronic device in a landscape orientation consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0040] FIG. **37** illustrates a rear elevation view of a multi-pivot stand consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0041] FIG. **38** illustrates a side elevation view of a multi-pivot stand consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0042] FIG. **39** illustrates a multi-pivot stand including a case coupled to a vertical support consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0043] FIG. **40** illustrates a release lever configured to selectively release an upper connection member of a multi-pivot stand in order to rotate a case from a landscape orientation to a portrait orientation consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0044] FIG. **41** illustrates another view of the release lever illustrated in FIG. **40** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0045] FIG. **42** illustrates another multi-pivot stand including a case configured to secure a portable electronic device capable of rotating from a landscape orientation to a portrait orientation consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0046] FIG. **43** illustrates a multi-pivot stand including a case configured to vertically pivot about an upper connection member consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0047] FIG. **44** illustrates another view of the multi-pivot stand illustrated in FIG. **43** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0048] FIG. **45** illustrates a multi-pivot stand including a case configured to horizontally pivot about an upper connection member consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0049] FIG. **46** illustrates another view of the multi-pivot stand illustrated in FIG. **45** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0050] FIG. **47** illustrates a component view of a multi-pivot stand including a base, a lower

connection member, a vertical support, and upper connection member, and a case configured to secure a portable electronic device consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0051] FIG. **48** illustrates a base and a vertical support configured to be pivotably coupled via a lower connection member consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0052] FIG. **49** illustrates a base and a vertical support configured to be pivotably coupled via another lower connection member consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0053] FIG. **50** illustrates an exemplary base and vertical support configured to be pivotably coupled via a lower connection member consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0054] FIG. **51** illustrates a holder for a portable electronic device consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0055] FIG. **52** illustrates another view of the holder illustrated in FIG. **51** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0056] FIG. **53** illustrates a holder for a portable electronic device in a handheld configuration consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0057] FIG. **54** illustrates another view of the holder illustrated in FIG. **53** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0058] FIG. **55** illustrates a component view of the holder illustrated in FIG. **53** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0059] FIG. **56** illustrates another view of the holder illustrated in FIG. **53** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0060] FIG. **57** illustrates the holder illustrated in FIG. **54** in a stand configuration consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0061] FIG. **58** illustrates another view of the holder illustrated in FIG. **57** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0062] FIG. **59** illustrates a rotatable holder for a portable electronic device in a handheld configuration consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0063] FIG. **60** illustrates another view of the rotatable holder illustrated in FIG. **59** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0064] FIG. **61** illustrates a component view of the rotatable holder illustrated in FIG. **59** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0065] FIG. **62** illustrates another view of the rotatable holder illustrated in FIG. **59** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0066] FIG. **63** illustrates a handheld holder for a portable electronic device consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0067] FIG. **64** illustrates another view of the handheld holder illustrated in FIG. **63** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0068] FIG. **65** illustrates another view of the handheld holder illustrated in FIG. **63** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0069] FIG. **66** illustrates a handheld holder for a portable electronic device consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0070] FIG. **67** illustrates another view of the handheld holder illustrated in FIG. **66** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0071] FIG. **68** illustrates a case for a portable electronic device consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0072] FIG. **69** illustrates another view of the case illustrated in FIG. **68** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0073] FIG. **70** illustrates a handheld holder for a portable electronic device consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0074] FIG. **71** illustrates a rotatable coupling mechanism consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0075] FIG. **72** illustrates another view of the rotatable coupling mechanism illustrated in FIG. **71** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0076] FIG. **73** illustrates another view of the rotatable coupling mechanism illustrated in FIG. **71** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0077] FIG. **74** illustrates a rotatable case for a portable electronic device oriented in a landscape configuration consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0078] FIG. **75** illustrates the rotatable case illustrated in FIG. **74** oriented in a portrait configuration consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0079] FIG. **76** illustrates the rotatable case illustrated in FIG. **74** configured in a stowage mode consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0080] FIG. **77** illustrates a rear perspective view of the rotatable case illustrated in FIG. **74** oriented in a landscape consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0081] FIG. **78** illustrates a support for a portable electronic device consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0082] FIG. **79** illustrates the support illustrated in FIG. **78** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0083] FIG. **80** illustrates the support illustrated in FIG. **78** configured in a portrait orientation consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0084] FIG. **81** illustrates the support illustrated in FIG. **78** configured in a landscape orientation consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0085] FIG. **82** illustrates a rotatable support for a portable electronic device consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0086] FIG. **83** illustrates the rotatable support illustrated in FIG. **82** configured in a landscape orientation consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0087] FIG. **84** illustrates another view of the rotatable support illustrated in FIG. **82** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0088] FIG. **85** illustrates a handheld holder for a portable electronic device consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0089] FIG. **86** illustrates a rear perspective view of the handheld holder illustrated in FIG. **85** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0090] FIG. **87** illustrates a support for a portable electronic device consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0091] FIG. **88** illustrates a rear perspective view of the support illustrated in FIG. **87** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0092] FIG. **89** illustrates the support illustrated in FIG. **87** receiving a portable electronic device consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0093] FIG. **90** illustrates a rotatable case for a portable electronic device oriented in a landscape configuration consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0094] FIG. **91** illustrates the rotatable case illustrated in FIG. **90** configured in a stowage mode consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0095] FIG. **92** illustrates a rotatable case for a portable electronic device including an integrated keyboard oriented in a portrait configuration consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0096] FIG. **93** illustrates the rotatable case illustrated in FIG. **92** oriented in a landscape configuration consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0097] FIG. **94** illustrates the rotatable case illustrated in FIG. **92** configured in a stowage mode consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0098] FIG. **95** illustrates a rear perspective view of the rotatable case illustrated in FIG. **92** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0099] FIG. **96** illustrates a rotatable case for a portable electronic device including an integrated

keyboard oriented in a landscape configuration consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0100] FIG. **97** illustrates a rear perspective view of the rotatable case illustrated in FIG. **96** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0101] FIG. **98** illustrates the rotatable case illustrated in FIG. **96** oriented in a portrait configuration consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0102] FIG. **99** illustrates the rotatable case illustrated in FIG. **96** configured in a stowage mode consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0103] FIG. **100** illustrates a support for a portable electronic device consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0104] FIG. **101** illustrates a front perspective view the support illustrated in FIG. **100** consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0105] FIG. **102** illustrates the support illustrated in FIG. **100** configured in a stowage mode consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0106] FIG. **103** illustrates an interaction between a support panel of a rotatable case for a portable electronic device and a securing panel via a selectively detachable rotational mechanism consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0107] FIG. **104** illustrates an interaction of a selectively detachable rotational mechanism and a securing panel of a rotatable case for a portable electronic device consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure; and

[0108] FIG. **105** illustrates a rotatable case including a user interface consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0109] The proliferation of portable electronic devices (PEDs), including notebook and tablet computers (e.g., the Apple® iPad™), portable digital assistants (PDAs), and smartphones, has placed more computing power into the hands of users than the computing power of early computers that occupied an entire room. This portable computing power has enhanced both personal and business mobile productivity. Due to their portability, however, PEDs may be susceptible to damage. In addition, PEDs may allow for viewing in a variety of orientations (e.g., portrait and/or landscape), but may not be configured to be easily used in multiple orientations.

[0110] Embodiments of the present disclosure provide an accessory case for a PED configured to protect the PED from damage. In some embodiments, the accessory case may be configured to enclose the PED and rotatably support the PED in at least two orientations. In various embodiments, the case may be configured to enclose and protect the PED in a closed position and support the PED upright and/or elevated (i.e., propped up) in an open position.

[0111] Embodiments may be best understood by reference to the drawings. In certain instances, like features may be designated with like reference numerals. It will be readily understood that the components of the present disclosure, as generally described and illustrated in the drawings herein, could be arranged and designed in a wide variety of different configurations. Thus, the following more detailed description of the embodiments of the apparatus is not intended to limit the scope of the disclosure, but is merely representative of possible embodiments of the disclosure. In some cases, well-known structures, materials, or operations are not shown or described in detail.

[0112] FIGS. **1-4** illustrate a case **100** for a PED **102** that can be used to assist in viewing the PED **102**. The illustrated case **100** may be referred to as a holder, sleeve, mount, and the like and, as used herein, does not necessarily imply an encasing or retaining functionality, although some embodiments of the case **100** may have such functionalities. The PED **102** may be any portable electronic device including, for example, a notebook computer, an electronic book reader (e.g., the Amazon® Kindle™), a smartphone (e.g., the Apple® iPhone™, the Motorola® Droid®, and the BlackBerry® Storm™), and/or a tablet computer (e.g., the Apple® iPad™, the HP® Slate, and the Samsung® Galaxy™ Tablet).

[0113] The case **100** can be configured to receive a PED **102**, and may further function to retain, carry, and protect the PED **102**. The PED **102** can include on the front and/or the back face of the PED **102** a display **104** that is viewable in either a portrait orientation or a landscape orientation, a user input (not shown), and a data input/output port (not shown). In some embodiments, the case **100** may be configured such that the display **104**, user input, and data input/output port are accessible by a user of the PED **102** while the PED **102** is disposed in the case **100**. Further, in some embodiments, the case **100** may include a protective display disposed over the display **104**.

[0114] The case **100** can assist a user in viewing the PED **102** when the display **104** is functioning in either the portrait or landscape orientation. This can be particularly advantageous, as users of a PED **102** may desire to alternate between using the PED **102** in the portrait and landscape orientations. Moreover, some users may prefer to use a PED **102** exclusively in either the portrait mode or the landscape mode. Since either group of users could use the case **100** effectively, the case **100** can advantageously serve to reduce sellers' inventories.

[0115] The case **100** may include a base **106**, a support member **108**, and a holder **110**. The support member **108** and the holder **110** may be attached to each other at a rotatable connector **112**. In the illustrated embodiment, the base **106** includes a platform **114** that can rest on a planar or substantially planar working surface, such as a floor or table top. The base **106** may define a series of channels **116** at a front end thereof. The support member **108** may include a post **118** that is fixedly secured to the platform **114**. For example, the post **118** and the platform **114** may be integrally molded from a single piece of material (e.g., plastic), or they may be fixedly secured to each other in any other suitable manner. The illustrated post **118** thus may not be rotatable relative to the platform **114**.

[0116] The rotatable connector **112** or rotational mechanism may be located at an upper end of the post **118**. The connector may include a ball-and-socket joint **120**, which permits rotation about three mutually perpendicular axes. Stated otherwise, the ball-and-socket joint **120** may permit the holder **110** to rotate about an axis defined by the post **118** (as indicated at the double-headed arrow **122**), and also permit the holder **110** to rotate about two mutually orthogonal axes that are each perpendicular to the axis defined by the post **118** (as indicated at the double-headed arrows **122** and **124**).

[0117] The holder **110** may be configured to grip or otherwise secure the PED **102**. In certain embodiments, the holder **110** may include a sleeve **128**, which may also be referred to as a pocket or a pouch, that is configured to retain therein the PED **102**. For example, the sleeve **128** may comprise a resilient material that can selectively expand so as to receive the PED **102** through a front opening and resiliently close about an outer edge of the PED **102**. The holder **110** and/or sleeve **128** may also be configured to substantially cover the entirety of a back face of the PED **102**. In some embodiments, the holder **110** and/or sleeve **128** may comprise a rubber or other elastomeric material (e.g., silicone) configured to provide a secure friction fit around the perimeter of the PED **102** to secure the holder **110** and/or sleeve **128** around the PED **102**. The holder **110** and/or sleeve **128** may also comprise rigid materials (e.g., plastic, metal, and the like) and include a rigid frame. In some embodiments, the holder **110** and/or sleeve **128** may comprise releasable clips, straps, or other locking features that allow for the PED **102** to be selectively locked into the holder **110** and selectively released from the holder **110**.

[0118] FIGS. 1-3 illustrate the case **100** in a portrait orientation which can assist a user in viewing a PED **102** when the display **104** is oriented in a landscape mode. The holder **110** can be rotated about one axis (shown by the arrow **124**) so as to adjust a pitch of the PED **102**. A bottom edge of the holder **110** thus can be situated in any of the channels **116**. As shown in FIG. 2, the channels **116** may be substantially linear, such that rotation about another axis (shown by the arrow **126**) may be restricted when the bottom edge of the holder **110** is situated within a channel **116**.

[0119] As illustrated in FIGS. 3-4, the holder **110** can be rotated in another direction (shown by the arrow **122**) so as to transition the case **100** from a portrait orientation to a landscape orientation. In

the illustrated embodiment, the ball-and-socket joint **120** may be off-center relative to a width of the holder **110** and centered relative to a height of the holder **110** (“width” and “height” referring to the portrait orientation) such that a height of that portion of the holder **100** which is below the ball-and-socket joint **120** is the same or substantially similar when the holder **110** is in either of the portrait and landscape orientations. As a result, a bottom edge of the holder **110** can seat equally well in any of the channels **116** in either orientation. In such an arrangement, the holder **110** may be off-center relative to the base **106** when it is in the portrait orientation and centered relative to the base **106** in the landscape orientation.

[0120] In other embodiments, the ball-and-socket joint **120** may be centered relative to both the width and height of the holder **110**. As the support member **108** may be fixed relative to the base **106**, this may result in a different interaction between the bottom edge of the holder **110** and the channels **116** when the PED **102** is in the portrait and landscape orientations. For example, some channels **116** may be accessible in one orientation, but inaccessible in another. In some embodiments, the connector **112** can include a slide **130** or other suitable feature in addition to the ball-and-socket joint **120** so as to permit centering of the holder **110**.

[0121] Other arrangements than those specifically described with respect to the embodiments illustrated in FIGS. **1-4** are contemplated. For example, in some embodiments, the base **106** may not include a platform **114** that is solid between its outer edges. In other or further embodiments, the support member **108** may be substantially wider than the post **118**. In other or further embodiments, the holder **110** may not secure the PED **102** therein, but the PED **102** may rest on the holder **110**. Moreover, for embodiments in which the PED **102** is secured to the holder **110**, any suitable connectors, straps, holders, or other devices may be used to secure the PED **102** to the holder **110**. In some embodiments, the holder **110** may include a clear protective sheet (e.g., a sheet of plastic) that covers a display **104** of the PED **110**. The holder **110** may include an opening at a side or top edge thereof through which the PED **102** may be introduced into the holder **110**. In still other or further embodiments, the rotatable connector **112** may not include a ball-and-socket joint **120**, but instead may include another suitable connection system that permits rotation about at least two mutually orthogonal axes. In some embodiments, the ball-and-socket joint **120** may be self-tensioning, and in further embodiments, the channels **116** are not used. In embodiments where the channels **116** are not used, the bottom edge of the holder **110** may be secured to the base **106** using alternative suitable connectors including, for example, straps, snaps, hook and loop fasteners, and the like.

[0122] FIGS. **5-10** illustrate another case **200** for a PED **102** that can be used to assist in viewing a PED **102**. In certain embodiments, case **200** may include similar features to case **100** illustrated in FIGS. **1-4**. Accordingly, like features may be designated in certain instances, but not all, with like reference numerals. Relevant disclosure set forth above regarding similarly identified features also may not be repeated hereafter. Moreover, specific features of the case **100** illustrated in FIGS. **1-4** may not be shown or identified by reference numerals in the drawings or specifically discussed in the written description that follows. However, such features may clearly be the same, or substantially the same, as features depicted in other embodiments and/or described with respect to such embodiments. Accordingly, the relevant descriptions of such features apply equally to the features of the case **200**. Any suitable combination of the features and variations of the same described with respect to the case **100** can be employed with the case **200**, and vice versa. This pattern of disclosure applies equally to further embodiments depicted in subsequent figures and described hereafter.

[0123] As illustrated in FIG. **5**, the case **200** may include a base **202** that comprises a display cover **204** that in certain configurations, may function as a platform. The case **200** may further include a post **206** that is attached to the display cover **204** at a hinge **208**. The hinge **208** can provide the base **202** with one or more additional degrees of freedom in adjusting a viewing position of a holder **210**, as indicated by the double arrow **212**. This may also facilitate centering of the holder

210 in either a portrait or landscape orientation, as shown in FIG. 7 and FIG. 8.

[0124] In certain embodiments, the case **200** can transition between various open orientations, as shown in FIGS. 5-7 (i.e., open, portrait) and FIG. 8 (i.e., open, landscape), and a closed orientation, as shown in FIGS. 9-10. In the illustrated embodiment, the case **200** is in the landscape orientation when it is closed. When the case **200** is closed, the holder **210** can encase a periphery and back face of the PED **102**, and the display cover **204** can cover a front face of the PED **102**, which include a display **104**. The post **206** may be bent to facilitate alignment of the holder **210** and the display cover **204**.

[0125] FIGS. 11-12 illustrate another case **300** for a PED **102** that can be used to assist in viewing the PED **102**. In certain embodiments, the case **300** can include a platform **302** that defines an opening **304**. In some embodiments, the opening **304** may be sufficiently large to receive a lower edge of a holder **306** therein in either a landscape or portrait orientation. The holder **306** can include a support wall **308** and one or more connectors **310**, such as resilient straps, that may be configured to hold the PED **102** against the support wall **308**.

[0126] FIGS. 13-14 illustrate another case **400** for a PED **102** that can be used to assist in viewing the PED **102**. In certain embodiments, the case **400** can include a platform **402** that defines two support legs **404** and a holder **408**. The holder **408** can include a support wall **410** and two or more rests **412**, **414** that extend from the support wall **410**. The PED **102** can rest against the support wall **410** and rest **412** when the holder **408** is configured for portrait orientation viewing, and can rest against the support wall **410** and rest **414** when the holder **408** is configured for landscape orientation viewing. In some embodiments, the PED **102** may not be physically secured to the holder **408**.

[0127] FIGS. 15-16 illustrate a case **500** configured to store items in addition to a PED **102**. The case **500** may include a holder **502** such as the holders described above. The holder **502** can comprise a back cover **504** and one or more connectors **506**, which can resemble the connectors described above. Other methods and devices for securing the PED **102** to the back cover **504** are also possible, including those discussed herein with respect to other embodiments. The back cover **504** can cover at least a portion of a rear face of the PED **102**.

[0128] In some embodiments, the back cover **504** may include a storage region **506**, which can be configured to store one or more accessories. For example, the storage region **506** can include one or more storage compartments **508**, which can receive one or more accessories therein. The accessories may be associated with the PED **102**, such as earphones (e.g., earbuds) **510**, a cleaning cloth **512**, cleaning solution **520**, cords (e.g., power cords), styluses, or the like. More or fewer compartments **508** than those shown in FIG. 15 may be used, and the compartments **508** may be of larger or smaller dimensions. Further, one or more accessories may be secured to the back cover **504** using other mechanical connection mechanisms including, for example, elastic straps.

[0129] As illustrated in FIGS. 15-16, the compartments **508** can be box-shaped, and may function as bins. The compartments **508** may have hinged or removable covers for ready access to the contents thereof. The illustrated compartments **508** can define a depth that is about the same or slightly greater than a thickness of the PED **102**. Accordingly, in the illustrated embodiment, a front cover **514** can be oriented substantially parallel to the back cover **504** when the case **500** is closed. In other embodiments, one or more of the compartments **508** may be shaped as sleeves or pouches. The sleeves may be sealable, such as via snaps, buttons, hook and pile fastener, or the like. In still other embodiments, one or more of the compartments **508** may be shaped as loops or elongated sleeves, which may be particularly suitable for receiving writing implements (e.g., pens, pencils, styluses) therein.

[0130] The front cover **514** may be connected to the back cover **504** in any suitable manner, such as via one or more hinges **516**, **518**. In the illustrated embodiment, two hinges **516**, **518** are present. A first hinge **518** may be positioned adjacent to a base of the storage region **506**, and a second hinge **516** may be spaced from the first hinge **518** such that when the case **500** is closed, the second hinge

516 is positioned adjacent to an upper face of the storage region **506**. Such an arrangement can aid in aligning the front and back covers **514**, **504** in a parallel configuration. In other embodiments, a single hinge can instead be used, which may be positioned at the upper face of the storage region **506**.

[0131] Other arrangements than those specifically described with respect to the embodiments illustrated in FIGS. **15-16** are contemplated. For example, in some embodiments, the storage region **506** is positioned on the front cover **514**, or portions thereof are positioned on each of the front and back covers **514**, **504**. In some embodiments, the storage region **506** may be positioned at an outer side edge of one or more of the covers **504**, **514**, and in still other or further embodiments, the storage region **506** may be positioned along a top and/or bottom edge of one or more of the covers **504**, **514**.

[0132] FIG. **17** illustrates a rotatable case **600** for a PED **102** configured in an open position. In certain embodiments, the rotatable case **600** may include similar features to the case **500** illustrated in FIGS. **15-16** and/or any combination of the various features and embodiments described in any of the cases and/or holders described herein.

[0133] In certain embodiments, the rotatable case **600** may include a rotational mechanism **602** coupling the PED **102** to the holder **502**, the back cover **504**, and/or via another PED securement mechanism allowing for variable rotation of the PED **102** relative to the rotatable case **600**. For example, as illustrated in FIG. **17**, the rotational mechanism **602** may include a rotational grommet coupling the PED **102** to the holder **502**, the back cover **504**, and/or via another PED securement mechanism allowing for variable rotation of the PED **102** relative to the rotatable case **600**. In other embodiments, the rotational mechanism **602** may include a ratcheting swivel or pivot, a ball and socket mechanism, a temporary adhesive, a releasable latch, a clip, one or more buttons, a suction cup, and/or one or more straps allowing for rotational securement. In certain embodiments, the rotational mechanism **602** may snap into certain specific rotational orientations (e.g., portrait orientation and/or landscape orientation) and require rotational force to move to a different specific orientation. In alternative embodiments, the rotation mechanism **602** may not snap into specific orientations but may allow for rotational articulation in any number of orientations.

[0134] FIGS. **18-21** illustrate another case **700** for a PED **102** that can be used to assist in viewing a PED **102**. In certain embodiments, case **700** may include similar features to case **100** illustrated in FIGS. **1-4**, case **200** illustrated in FIGS. **5-10**, and/or any combination of the various features and embodiments described in any of the cases and/or holders described herein.

[0135] As illustrated in FIG. **18**, the case **700** may include a base **702** that comprises a display cover **704** that in certain configurations, may function as a platform. The case **700** may further include a post **706** that is attached to the display cover **704** at a hinge **708**. The hinge **708** can provide the base **702** with one or more additional degrees of freedom in adjusting a viewing position of a holder **710**. This may also facilitate centering of the holder **710** in either a portrait or landscape orientation, as shown respectively in FIG. **20** and FIG. **21**.

[0136] In certain embodiments, the case **700** may include a rotational grommet **712** coupling the PED **102** and/or the holder **710** to the post **706** allowing for variable rotation of the PED **102** and/or the holder **710** relative to the post **706** in one or more directions. In certain embodiments, the rotational grommet **712** may snap into certain specific rotational orientations (e.g., portrait orientation and/or landscape orientation) and require rotational force to move to a different specific orientation. In alternative embodiments, the rotational grommet **712** may not snap into specific orientations but may allow for rotational articulation in any number of orientations.

[0137] FIG. **22** illustrates a rotatable case **800** in a landscape orientation. As illustrated, the rotatable case **800** includes a securing panel **802** configured to secure a PED (not shown). According to various embodiments, the rotatable case **800** may include various access ports (such as **804** and **806**) to facilitate interfacing a PED disposed within the case **800** with connector plugs, cables, headphones, speakers, and/or power adaptors. In certain embodiments, the rotatable case

800 may include built-in cords to route power, connectivity, and/or headphone cables from a PED to an external device. Moreover, according to various embodiments, a battery may be built into a panel or pocket of rotatable case **800**.

[0138] In certain embodiments, the rotatable case **800** may have the ability to rotate securing panel **802** with respect to a supporting panel **808** and a base panel **810**. Any of a wide variety of rotatable securing devices may be employed to rotatably secure securing panel **802** to supporting panel **808**. For example, bushings, flanged bushings, grommets, rivets, eyelets, plain bearings, bearings, and/or any combination thereof may be employed to rotatably secure securing panel **802** to supporting panel **808**. For example, as illustrated, a grommet **812** may be configured to rotatably secure the securing panel **802** to the supporting panel **808**. In some embodiments, the grommet **812** may comprise a ring that may allow a logo to show through the hole in the middle of grommet **812**. In certain embodiments, one or more interchangeable accessories and/or inserts may “snap” into the hole in the middle of grommet **812** including, for example, a logo insert, a proximity alarm or other loss prevention accessory, and the like. Alternatively, the hold in the middle of grommet **812** may define an opening and/or aperture that may allow viewing of the interior of the rotatable case **800** and/or a portion of a PED (not shown) disposed therein (e.g., a portion of the PED including a logo)

[0139] The base panel **812** may be configured with channels or groves **814** to secure the bottom edge of securing panel **802** when the securing panel **802** is in an upright and/or elevated position. According to various alternative embodiments, in place of channels **814** a frictional surface (e.g., rubberized surface or the like) or frictional contact patches may be utilized to secure the bottom edge of the securing panel **802** in an upright and/or elevated position.

[0140] The supporting panel **808** may be configured to provide a counterforce to the securing panel **802** in order to support securing panel **802** in an upright and/or elevated position. As illustrated, the supporting panel **808** and the base panel **810** may comprise a single panel folded or bent at **816**. According to various embodiments, the relative proportions of the base panel **810** and the supporting panel **808** may be adapted for a particular application. Further, in certain embodiments, the rotatable case **800** may be configured to support a PED at one or more angles relative to the base panel **810** and in a plurality of orientations, including portrait and landscape.

[0141] FIG. 23 illustrates a rotatable case **800** for a PED **102** rotated into a portrait orientation. Similar to the embodiments illustrated in FIG. 1, the base panel **810** may include one or more channels **814** configured to secure the bottom edge of a PED **102** and/or the bottom edge of a securing panel **802**. The rotatable case may further include a supporting panel **808** configured to fold at **816** with respect to the base panel **810**.

[0142] A comparison of FIG. 22 and FIG. 23 illustrates the ability to rotate the securing panel **802** with respect to supporting panel **808** consistent with embodiments disclosed herein. According to various embodiments, the grommet **812** may allow a PED **102** to be rotated from a landscape orientation, as illustrated in FIG. 22, to the portrait orientation illustrated in FIG. 23.

[0143] In certain embodiments, the securing panel **802**, base panel **810**, and/or supporting panel **808** may provide protection to an enclosed PED **102**. For example, the securing panel **802**, base panel **810**, and/or supporting panel **808** may be configured to protect the PED **102** from scratches, from damage as a result of a fall, from extreme temperatures, and/or other conditions that may result in damage to the PED **102**. Accordingly, any portion of the rotating case **800** may be reinforced with padding, metal, plastic, cardboard, rubber, and/or other material or combination thereof.

[0144] In certain embodiments, the reinforcing material may utilize various folds, bends, and/or curvatures to obtain desirable resistance and/or resilience characteristics. For example, fold **816** may be configured to function as a bi-stable, tri-stable, or N-stable fold, allowing a user to selectively fold the support panel **808** with respect to the base panel **810** into one or more predetermined angles. In some embodiments, by providing an N-stable fold **816**, the support panel

808 may effectively “snap” into one or more predetermined positions in order to support the PED **102** at predetermined angles with respect to the base panel **810**.

[0145] FIG. **24** illustrates a rotatable case **800** in a closed position securing a PED **102** therein. As illustrated, the securing panel **802** may include one or more access ports **804**. A grommet **812** may serve to rotatably secure the support panel **808** to securing panel **802**. In certain embodiments, the grommet **812** may include a see-through center circle making a portion of the PED **102** visible even when rotatable case **802** is in a closed position. In some embodiments, a transparent material may cover the center of the circle made by grommet **812**. According to other embodiments, the center circle of grommet **812** may be filled with any type of material, including the same type of material used for the support panel **808** and/or the securing panel **802**.

[0146] The support panel **808** may comprise a lower portion **818** and a pivot flap **820**. The pivot flap **820** may be configured to fold or pivot with respect to the lower portion **818** of the support panel **808**. As illustrated, the grommet **812** may be secured to the pivot flap **820**, allowing the grommet **812** and the securing panel **802** to pivot with respect to the lower portion **818** of the supporting panel **808**.

[0147] Any of a variety of fasteners (not shown) may be employed to selectively maintain the rotatable case **800** in the closed position. For example, a fastener may be configured to selectively maintain the securing panel **802** parallel to base panel **810**. The fastener may comprise any of a variety of fasteners commonly employed in cases, bags, and luggage. Examples of possible closure mechanisms include, but are not limited to, straps, buttons, flaps, snaps, Velcro, hooks, clasps, clips, and combinations thereof. In certain embodiments, the ends of an elastic strap may be secured to the base panel **810** and the strap may be selectively wrapped around the securing panel **802**. Accordingly, the securing panel **802** may be elastically maintained in a closed position. Additionally, though not illustrated, the rotatable case **800** may include any of a wide variety of straps, handles, harnesses, and/or the like configured to enable a user to easily transport the rotatable case **800**.

[0148] FIG. **25** illustrates a rotatable case **800** securing a PED **102** in a landscape orientation and a first opened position. As illustrated, the support panel **808** may be folded at **816** with respect to the base panel **810**. The grommet **812** may be configured to rotatably secure the securing panel **802** with respect to the support panel **808**. In certain embodiments, the grommet **812** may rotatably secure a pivot flap **820** of the support panel **808** to the securing panel **802**, thereby allowing the securing panel **802** to be pivoted with respect to a lower portion **818** of the support panel **808**. In some embodiments, the grommet **812** may allow a portion of the PED **102** to be seen through the center ring. For example, a logo included on the PED **102** may be visible.

[0149] As previously described, the base panel **810** may include one or more channels **814** configured to prevent a bottom edge of the securing panel **802** from slipping when in an upright and/or elevated supported position. Alternative features may be utilized in place of the one or more channels **814** including, for example, frictional contact patches, catches, magnets, protrusions, and/or other features configured to prevent a bottom edge of the securing panel **802** from slipping. In certain embodiments, the securing panel **802** may include one or more access ports, such as a headphone access port **804**.

[0150] FIG. **26** illustrates a rotatable case **800** supporting a PED (not shown) at an angle in a landscape orientation and in a second opened position. Particularly, FIG. **26** illustrates the functionality of the pivot flap **820** (not visible) included in rotatable case **800**. As previously described, by folding a pivot flap **820** with respect to lower portion **818** of the support panel **808**, the securing panel **802** may be pivoted with respect to the supporting panel **808**. In the illustrated position, the support panel **808** supports the securing panel **802** at an angle with respect to the base panel **810**. A first channel of channels **814** prevents a bottom edge of the securing panel **802** from slipping along the base panel **810**. In certain embodiments, additional folding of the pivot flap **820** and/or the support panel **808** at **816** may allow the PED **102** to be supported at various angles of

inclination by placing the bottom edge of the securing panel **802** in a different channel of channels **814**. In certain embodiments, the securing panel **802** may include one or more access ports, such as a headphone access port **804**.

[0151] FIG. **27** illustrates a PED **102** secured by a rotatable case **800** including a pivot flap **820** (not visible) configured to allow the PED **102** to be pivoted to a desired angle of inclination. The pivot flap **820** (not visible) may allow the PED **102** to be secured within the securing panel **802** to pivot with respect to the support panel **808**. As illustrated, the PED **102** may be pivoted into a desired angle of inclination. In certain embodiments, the PED **102** may be pivoted from the closed position illustrated in FIG. **24**, in which the PED **102** is parallel to base panel **810**, to any angle of inclination between with respect to the base panel **810**. Accordingly, the PED **102** may be pivoted until the securing panel **802** is again parallel with the base panel **810** and with the display **104** of the PED **102** facing up.

[0152] In certain embodiments, the PED **102** secured by the securing panel **802** may be pivoted to a desired angle of inclination. The support panel **808** may provide sufficient support to maintain the PED **102** at the desired angle of inclination. One or more channels **814** may prevent a bottom edge of the securing panel **810** from slipping along the base panel **810**.

[0153] FIG. **28** illustrates a PED **102** secured by a rotatable case **800** including a grommet **812** (not visible) configured to allow the PED **102** to be rotated from a portrait orientation to a landscape orientation and vice versa. As illustrated, a rotatable grommet **812** (not visible) may be configured to allow a PED **102** disposed in a securing panel **802** to be rotated from a portrait orientation to a landscape orientation and vice versa. In certain embodiments, the PED **102** may be configured to rotate from a first landscape position, as illustrated in FIG. **22** to a second portrait position, as illustrated in FIG. **23**. In certain embodiments, the PED **102** may be rotated 360 degrees into any desired orientation.

[0154] In some embodiments, the PED **102** may be configured to rotate only into specific orientations. For example, at 0 degrees the PED **102** may be in a first landscape orientation; the PED **102** may be rotated 90 degrees to a first portrait orientation, rotated an additional 90 degrees to a second landscape orientation, and rotated a final 90 degrees to a second portrait position. In the second portrait position it may reach a stop and may be rotated in the opposite direction to return the PED **102** to prior orientations. In certain embodiments, the rotational mechanism (e.g., grommet **812**) of the case **800** may snap into certain specific orientations and require rotational force to move to a different specific orientation.

[0155] FIG. **29** illustrates a rear view of a rotatable case **800** securing a PED **102** in a portrait orientation. As illustrated, a pivot flap **820** may be folded with respect to a lower portion **818** of the support panel **808**. Accordingly, a PED **102** secured by the securing panel **802** may be supported at one or more specific angles with respect to the support panel **808** and the base panel **810** (not visible). A grommet **812** or other rotational mechanism may rotatably secure the securing panel **802** to the pivot flap **820**. As previously described, the grommet **812** may allow the PED **102** and the securing panel **802** to be rotated with respect to the support panel **808**, including, for example, in a portrait and/or landscape orientation.

[0156] FIG. **30** illustrates an interaction between a support panel **808** of a rotatable case **800** and a securing panel **802** via a grommet **812**. In certain embodiments, the grommet **812** may comprise a rear portion **812** and a front portion **822**. The rotatable case **800** may include a base panel **810** with one or more channels **814**, a supporting panel **808** comprising a lower portion **818**, and a pivot flap **820**, and a rear portion **812** of the grommet. A securing panel **802**, including one or more access ports **804**, may be mounted to a front portion **822** of the grommet. According to various embodiments, the front portion **822** of the grommet may be mated with the rear portion **812** of the grommet in order to rotatably secure the securing panel **802** to the pivot flap **820**. In this manner, the securing panel **802** may be free to rotate 360 degrees relative to the support panel **808**.

[0157] In certain embodiments, the front portion **822** of the grommet and the rear portion **812** of

the grommet may be joined together during manufacturing or assembly and are not configured to be selectively separated by a user. Alternatively, a user may selectively separate the front portion **822** of the grommet from the rear portion **812** in order to remove the securing panel **802** from the pivot flap **820**. In other embodiments, the front portion **822** and the rear portion **812** of the grommet are inseparable and the grommet may be selectively detachable from the pivot flap **820** and/or the securing panel **102**.

[0158] FIG. **31** illustrates a securing panel **802** of a rotatable case **800** and a front portion of a grommet **822**. The securing panel **802** may include sidewalls to protect and/or secure the edges of a PED **102** (not shown). According to various embodiments, a PED **102** may effectively snap into place within the securing panel **802**. Alternatively, a PED **102** may be secured within the securing panel **802** utilizing one or more straps, buckles, clips, adhesives, and/or similar features. The securing panel **802** may further utilize neoprene or rubber to selectively secure the PED **102**. Additionally, the sidewalls, or a portion thereof, of the securing panel **802** may wrap around the front of a secured PED **102**. In certain embodiments, the securing panel **802** may comprise a holder similar to the holders described herein.

[0159] The securing panel **802** may further include one or more access ports **804**, **806**, **824**. For example, a headphone access port **804**, a volume rocker access port **806**, and/or a power or connection access port **824** may be available. As previously described, a grommet portion **822** may be configured to rotatably secure the securing panel **802** to a pivot flap **820** of a support panel **808**. The securing panel **802** may comprise various materials such as plastic, rubber, metal, leather, faux leather, vinyl, nylon, and/or any of a wide variety of alternative decorative or useful materials utilized in cases, bags, luggage, and the like.

[0160] FIG. **32** illustrates a support panel **808** of a rotatable case **800** including a pivot flap **820** and a grommet **812**. As illustrated, the pivot flap **820** may include a grommet **812** and be configured to fold with respect to a lower portion **818** of the support panel **808**. Accordingly, the pivot flap **820** and grommet **812** may pivot with respect to the lower portion **818** of the support panel **808** to a desired angle of inclination. According to various embodiments, the pivot flap **820** may be configured to resiliently return to its original, unfolded, position when the pivoting force is removed. Alternatively, the pivot flap **820** may be configured to pivot with respect to a lower portion **818** of the support panel **808** and thereafter maintain the pivoted position until forced to a new angle of inclination.

[0161] The pivot flap **820** may be connected to a lower portion **818** of the support panel **808** utilizing any of a variety of known pivotable connectors. In some embodiments, the support panel **808**, including both the lower portion **818** and the pivot flap **820** may be manufactured using a material or fabric, such as leather, faux leather, and/or vinyl. In such embodiments, the pivotable connection between the pivot flap **820** and the lower portion **818** of the support panel **808** may be a sewn section of a similar or identical material.

[0162] FIG. **33** illustrates a rotatable case **800** integrated into a larger case **826**. As illustrated, the rotatable case **800** may be integrated as an additional side pocket on a larger case **826**. According to various embodiments, the rotatable case **800** may alternatively be integrated within an internal compartment of larger case **826**. Additionally, in certain embodiments, a base panel **810** may be a shared panel or wall of the larger case **826**; and thus only include the remaining portions of the rotatable case **800**. That is, a wall of larger case **826** may share a common wall with the base panel **810** of rotatable case **800**.

[0163] In certain embodiments, the rotatable case **800** may include any combination of the various features and embodiments described in any of the cases described herein. Moreover, the larger case **826** may be configured with a handle **830** and a zipper **828**. The larger case **826** may be any of a wide variety of cases, including a brief case, luggage, a laptop case, a case for a PED **102**, and the like.

[0164] FIG. **34** illustrates a multi-pivot stand **900** for a PED (not shown) including a base **902**, a

vertical support **904**, and a case **906** configured in a landscape orientation. In certain embodiments, the base **902** may be constructed of any shape and/or size suitable to adequately support a PED secured within the case **906**. In some embodiments, the base **902** may be weighted, include adjustable feet, have a no-slip bottom and/or top surface, and/or include a logo disposed thereon. [0165] A vertical support **904** may be coupled to the base **902** via a lower connection member **908**. In certain embodiments, the lower connection member **908** may comprise a swivel joint configured to allow the vertical support **904** to be rotated and pivoted in a variety of angles and directions with respect to the base **902**. In some embodiments, the lower connection member **908** may comprise a swivel joint configured to allow the vertical support **904** to be rotated but not pivoted, pivoted but not rotated, or rotated and pivoted. The lower connection member may further comprise any variety of known rotatable and/or pivotable connections, including ball joints, ball and socket connections, bearings, pivot rods, slip rings, swivel joints, swing joints, and the like.

[0166] In certain embodiments, the lower connection member **908** may comprise a fixed connection member securing a vertical support **904** relative to the base **902**. The vertical support **904** and the base **902** may also be manufactured as a single piece, thereby limiting relative movement between the vertical support **904** and the base **902**.

[0167] The case **906** may be configured to securing a PED (not shown). In certain embodiments, the case **906** may comprise components and designs similar to the other cases and holders disclosed herein. The design of the case **906**, including its dimensions and positions of any access ports **910-914** may be adapted for a specific PED. In some embodiments, a PED may be configured to snap into the case **906** or be secured therein using one or more corner securement members (e.g., resilient straps). In certain embodiments, the case **906** may include flexible sidewalls configured to secure a PED. In some embodiments, the flexible sidewalls may be configured to secure a PED by wrapping around the sides and/or a portion of the front of a PED.

[0168] As is described in more detail below, the case **906** may be coupled to the vertical support **904** via an upper connection member (not visible) configured to allow the case **906** to be rotated and/or pivoted with respect to the vertical support **904**. In certain embodiments, the stand **900** may include a lever **916** configured to selectively lock and release the lower connection member **908** and or the upper connection member. The stand **900** may further include a plurality of levers configured, for example, to control one or more of the connection members separately.

[0169] FIG. 35 illustrates a multi-pivot stand **900** for a PED (not shown) including a data dock **918**. In certain embodiments, the data dock **918** may be configured to provide power and/or a data connection to a PED secured by a case **906**. In various embodiments, the data dock **918** may be communicatively coupled to an external connector **920** such as, for example, a USB connector and/or power connector, via a cable **922**. In some embodiments, the type, shape, size and number of data docks **918** may be adapted for a specific PED. In certain embodiments, the data dock **918** and the external connector **920** may be interchangeable with each other and/or other various alternative connectors.

[0170] FIG. 36 illustrates a multi-pivot stand **900** securing a PED **102** in a landscape orientation. As illustrated, the case portion **906** of the stand **900** may be configured to secure the PED **102** therein. In some embodiments, the PED **102** may be configured to snap into the case **906** using one or more corner securement members (e.g., resilient straps). In certain embodiments, the case **906** may include flexible sidewalls configured to secure the PED **906**. In some embodiments, the flexible sidewalls may be configured to secure the PED **906** by wrapping around the sides and/or a portion of the front of a PED **906** while still allowing a user to view the display **104**.

[0171] FIG. 37 illustrates a rear elevation view of a multi-pivot stand **900**. As illustrated, the stand **900** may include a case **906** coupled to a vertical support **904** via an upper connection member **926**. Additionally, the vertical support **904** may be coupled to a base **902** via a lower connection member **908** such that the vertical support **904** may be rotated and/or pivoted in one or more directions with respect to the base **902**. In certain embodiments, the upper connection member **926** may be a ball-

and-socket type connection allowing the case **906** to be rotated and pivoted in one or more directions with respect to the vertical support **904**. In certain embodiments, the upper connection member **926** may be generally described as a rotational mechanism. In various embodiments, the case may include one or more access ports **914** (e.g., power and/or data access ports).

[0172] A release lever **916** may be configured to selectively lock and release the upper connection member **926** and/or the lower connection member **908**. For example, when locked, the release lever **916** may be configured to selectively prevent the case **906** from pivoting and/or rotating in one or more directions relative to the vertical support **904**, the case **906**, and/or the base **902**. In certain embodiments, the release lever **916** may be specifically configured to selectively lock and/or release the vertical and horizontal pivoting of the case **906** relative to the vertical support **904**. In some embodiments, the case **906** may be configured to rotate from a portrait to a landscape orientation regardless of the state of the release lever **916**.

[0173] The case **906** may be secured to the upper connection member **926** via a mount **924**. In certain embodiments, the case **906** and/or upper connection member **926** may be selectively detached and/or attached from the mount **924**.

[0174] FIG. **38** illustrates a side elevation view of a multi-pivot stand **900**. The multi-pivot stand may include a vertical support **904** rotatably coupled to a base **902** via a lower connection member **908**. In certain embodiments, the lower connection member **908** may allow the vertical support **904** to be rotated and/or pivoted in one or more directions relative to the base **902**.

[0175] A case **906** configured to secure a PED (not shown) may be coupled to an upper connection member **926** via a mount **924**. Alternatively, the case **906** may be directly coupled to the upper connection member **926**. In certain embodiments, the upper connection member **926** may be configured to rotatably couple the case **906** to the vertical support **904** such that the case **906** may be pivoted and/or rotated in one or more directions relative to the vertical support **904**. A release lever **916** may be configured to selectively lock and release the movement of the upper connection member **926**.

[0176] FIG. **39** illustrates a multi-pivot stand **900** including a case **906** coupled to a vertical support **904**. In certain embodiments, the case **906** may be coupled to the vertical support **904** via an upper connection member **916** (shown in dashed lines). In some embodiments, the upper connection member **916** may be coupled to the case **906** via a mount **924** (shown in dashed lines).

[0177] The case **906** may be configured to pivot and/or rotate in one or more directions relative to the vertical support **904**. The vertical support **904** may be coupled to the base **902** via a lower connection member **908** and may be configured to pivot and/or rotate in one or more directions relative to the base **902**. A release lever **916** may be configured to selectively lock and release the upper connection member **926** and/or the lower connection member **908**.

[0178] In certain embodiments, the upper connection member **926** and/or the lower connection member **908** may be configured to frictionally maintain their positions when the PED (not shown) is secured within the case **906**. For example, in certain embodiments, even with the release lever **916** set to a position where the upper connection member **926** and the lower connection member **908** are free to rotate and/or pivot in one or more directions, friction may enable both connection members **926**, **908** to maintain their positions until acted on by an external force (e.g., from a user repositioning the stand **900**).

[0179] FIG. **40** illustrates a release lever **916** configured to selectively release an upper connection member (not visible) of a multi-pivot stand **900** in order to rotate a case **906** from a landscape orientation to a portrait orientation. As illustrated, the release lever **916** may be actuated by, for example, pulling it towards the case **906**. Alternatively, the release lever **916** may be actuated by movement in another direction, by rotation in a particular direction, by pulling the lever **916** outward, and/or by pushing the lever **916** inward. In certain other embodiments, the release lever **916** may be a release button or other mechanical device configured to selectively actuate the configuration of the upper connection member **926** and/or the lower connection member **908**.

[0180] FIG. **41** illustrates another view of the release lever **916** illustrated in FIG. **40**. As illustrated, when the release lever **916** is actuated, the case **906** may be freely rotated from a portrait orientation to a landscape orientation. In certain embodiments, the release lever **916** is actuated, the case **906** may be rotated in one or more directions to a plurality of orientations. Alternatively, the case **906** may be configured to lock (e.g., via a snapping mechanism or the like) into one or more locations and/or orientations corresponding to one or more pre-set orientations.

[0181] FIG. **42** illustrates another multi-pivot stand **900** including a case **906** configured to secure a PED (not shown) capable of rotating from a landscape orientation to a portrait orientation. In certain embodiments, a release lever (not shown) may need to be actuated prior to rotating the case **906** between orientations. Alternatively, the case **906** may be free to rotate independent of the release lever. In certain embodiments, the release lever may be configured to selectively prevent the case **906** from vertically and horizontally pivoting but not prevent it from rotating. In some embodiments, the case **906** may be figured to lock (e.g., snap) into one or more desired orientations (e.g., every 90 degrees and/or in portrait/landscape orientations). A vertical support **904** coupled to the case **906** may further be rotated and/or pivoted relative to a base **902**.

[0182] FIGS. **43-44** illustrate a multi-pivot stand **900** including a case **906** configured to vertically pivot about an upper connection member (not shown). A base **902** may be coupled to a vertical support **904** that, in certain embodiments, may be rotatable and/or pivotable in one or more directions relative to the base **902**. The vertical support **904** may be rotatably and/or pivotally coupled to the case **906** via an upper connection member (not visible). A release lever **916** may be configured to selectively lock and release the upper connection member and control the rotation and/or pivoting of the case **906** relative to the vertical support **904** and/or the vertical support **904** relative to the base **902**.

[0183] FIGS. **45-46** illustrate a multi-pivot stand **900** including a case **906** configured to horizontally pivot about an upper connection member (not shown). A base **902** may be coupled to a vertical support **904** that, in certain embodiments, may be rotatable and/or pivotable in one or more directions relative to the base **902**. The vertical support **904** may be rotatably and/or pivotally coupled to the case **906** via an upper connection member (not visible). The vertical support **904** may be further rotatably and/or pivotally coupled to the base **902** via a lower connection member **908**. A release lever **916** may be configured to selectively lock and release the upper connection member and/or the lower connection member **908** and control the rotation and/or pivoting of the case **906** relative to the vertical support **904** and/or the vertical support **904** relative to the base **902**. Using the upper connection member and/or lower connection member **908**, the case **906** may be horizontally rotated and/or pivoted with respect to the base **902** as illustrated. In certain embodiments, rotating and/or pivoting the case **906** may require that a release lever **916** be actuated.

[0184] FIG. **47** illustrates a component view of a multi-pivot stand including a base **902**, a lower connection member **908**, a vertical support **904**, an upper connection member **926**, and a case **906** configured to secure a PED. The stand may further include a release lever **916** and a mount **924** coupled to the case **906**.

[0185] The vertical support **904** may be rotatably and/or pivotally coupled to the base **902**. In certain embodiments, a lower connection member **908** may comprise a ball joint that is rigidly or rotatably coupled to the vertical support **904**. The lower connection member **908** may include a lower coupling pin **932** disposed thereon configured to be received by a lower coupling pin receptor **934** disposed in the base **902**. In certain embodiments, the lower coupling pin **932** may be securely received by the lower coupling pin receptor **934** using a compression and/or friction fit. In other embodiments, the lower coupling pin **932** may be securely received by the lower coupling pin receptor **934** using a threaded mechanism incorporated into the lower coupling pin **932** and/or the lower coupling pin receptor **934**. In further embodiments, the lower coupling pin **932** may be securely received by the lower coupling pin receptor **934** using a mechanical latching mechanism

incorporated into the lower coupling pin **932** and/or the lower coupling pin receptor **934**.

[0186] The vertical support **904** may be rotatably and/or pivotally coupled to the case **906**. In certain embodiments, an upper connection member **926** may comprise a ball joint that is rigidly or rotatably coupled to the case **906** via, in certain embodiments, a mount **924**. In some embodiments, the case **906** and/or upper connection member **926** may be selectively detached and/or attached from the mount **924**.

[0187] The upper connection member **926** may include an upper coupling pin **928** disposed thereon configured to be received by an upper coupling pin receptor **930** disposed in the vertical support **904**. In certain embodiments, the upper coupling pin **928** may be securely received by the upper coupling pin receptor **930** using a compression and/or friction fit. In other embodiments, the upper coupling pin **928** may be securely received by the upper coupling pin receptor **930** using a threaded mechanism incorporated into the upper coupling pin **928** and/or the upper coupling pin receptor **930**. In further embodiments, the upper coupling pin **928** may be securely received by the upper coupling pin receptor **930** using a mechanical latching mechanism incorporated into the upper coupling pin **928** and/or the upper coupling pin receptor **930**. In certain embodiments, a release lever **916** may be configured to selectively pivotally and/or rotationally lock and release the upper connection member **926** and/or the lower connection member **908**.

[0188] FIG. **48** illustrates a base **902** and a vertical support **904** configured to be pivotably coupled via a lower connection member **1002**, **1004**. As illustrated, the lower connection member may comprise a base ball **1004** rigidly coupled to the base **902**. A vertical support ball receptor **1002** coupled to the vertical support **904** may be configured to mechanically and/or frictionally grasp the base ball **1004**. In certain embodiments, the vertical support **904** may be rotated and/or pivoted relative to the base **902** via the lower connection member **1002**, **1004** independent of a selective release and locking mechanism such as, for example, a release lever. Alternatively, the vertical support **904** may be rotated and/or pivoted relative to the base **902** via the lower connection member **1002**, **1004** at varying degrees of resistance based on the actuation of a selective release and locking mechanism.

[0189] FIG. **49** illustrates a base **902** and a vertical support **904** configured to be pivotably coupled via another lower connection member **1006**, **1008**. As illustrated, the lower connection member may comprise a vertical support ball **1006** rigidly coupled to the vertical support **904**. A base ball receptor **1008** coupled to the base **902** may be configured to mechanically and/or frictionally grasp the vertical support ball **1006**. In certain embodiments, the vertical support **904** may be rotated and/or pivoted relative to the base **902** via the lower connection member **1006**, **1008** independent of a selective release and locking mechanism such as, for example, a release lever. Alternatively, the vertical support **904** may be rotated and/or pivoted relative to the base **902** via the lower connection member **1006**, **1008** at varying degrees of resistance based on the actuation of a selective release and locking mechanism.

[0190] FIG. **50** illustrates an exemplary base **1010** and vertical support **904** configured to be pivotably coupled via a lower connection member **932**, **934**. As illustrated, the base **1010** may include one or more leg members that may extend onto a surface the base **1010** rests upon. The vertical support **904** may be rotatably and/or pivotally coupled to the base **1010**. In certain embodiments, a lower connection member **908** may comprise a ball joint that is rigidly or rotatably coupled to the vertical support **904**. The lower connection member **908** may include a lower coupling pin **932** disposed thereon configured to be received by a lower coupling pin receptor **934** disposed in the base **902**. In certain embodiments, the lower coupling pin **932** may be securely received by the lower coupling pin receptor **934** using a compression and/or friction fit. In other embodiments, the lower coupling pin **932** may be securely received by the lower coupling pin receptor **934** using a threaded mechanism incorporated into the lower coupling pin **932** and/or the lower coupling pin receptor **934**. In further embodiments, the lower coupling pin **932** may be securely received by the lower coupling pin receptor **934** using a mechanical latching mechanism

incorporated into the lower coupling pin **932** and/or the lower coupling pin receptor **934**.

[0191] FIGS. **51-52** illustrate a holder **1100** for a PED. The holder **1100** may include a case **1102**, a hand grip **1104**, and a coupling mechanism **1106**, **1108** configured to securely attach the hand grip **1104** to the case **1102**. The case **1102** may be configured to receive, secure, and carry a PED and may incorporate features of other embodiments of cases disclosed herein.

[0192] The hand grip **1104** may include a base plate **1110** and a strap **1112** coupled to the base plate **1110**. In certain embodiments, a user may be able to slip a part of an appendage (e.g., a hand or forearm) between the base plate **1110** and the strap **1112** to secure the base plate **1110** to the user. In certain embodiments, the strap **1112** may be formed integrally with the base plate **1110**. In other embodiments, the strap **1112** may pass through and/or wrap around at least a portion of the base plate **1110**.

[0193] The inside of the strap **1112** and/or the base plate **1110** may be lined at least in part with a pad and/or soft material (e.g., microfiber) to provide comfortable use. In certain embodiments, the base plate **1110** may be a circular shape, as illustrated, to comfortably conform to the palm of a user's hand. In other embodiments, the base plate **1110** may comprise any suitable and/or ergonomic shape.

[0194] The coupling mechanism **1106**, **1108** may be configured to detachably secure the base plate **1110** of the hand grip **1104** to the case **1102**. In certain embodiments, the coupling mechanism **1106**, **1108** may couple the hand grip **1104** to the case in a manner that allows the hand grip **1104** to be rotatable relative to the case **1102**. In the illustrated embodiment, the coupling mechanism **1106**, **1108** comprises hooks and loops, such as Velcro®, which can easily be separated to allow rotation. For example, a loop portion **1108** may be securely attached to the case **1102**, and a hook portion **1106** may be securely attached to the hand grip **1104**.

[0195] The hand grip **1104** may be secured to the case **1102** when the hook portion **1106** and the loop portion **1108** come into contact. The hand grip **1104** can be rotated relative to the case **1102** by separating the hook portion **1106** and the loop portion **1108** (i.e., by separating the hand grip **1104** from the case **1102**), rotating the hand grip **1104** as desired, and recoupling the hook portion **1106** and the loop portion **1108**. In certain embodiments, the coupling mechanism **1106**, **1108** allows rotation of the case **1102** relative to the hand grip **1104** to any desired degree, including positions less than ninety degrees, thereby allowing the user to find a rotational orientation of the case **1102** that is comfortable. In other embodiments, the coupling mechanism **1106**, **1108** may be configured such that only selected orientations are permitted. For example, in one embodiment, the coupling mechanism **1106**, **1108** may be configured to only accept a rotational orientation of the case **1102** at 90 degree intervals.

[0196] The loop portion **1108** may be attached to the case **1102** with an adhesive. In another embodiment, the loop portion **1108** may be formed integrally with the case **1102**. Similarly, the hook portion **1106** may be attached to the base plate **1110** of the hand grip **1104** with an adhesive, or may be integrally formed with the base plate **1110**.

[0197] The coupling mechanism **1106**, **1108** can be any suitable securement device that allows the case **1102** to be rotated relative to the hand grip **1104**. For example, the coupling mechanism **1106**, **1108** may include a ratcheting swivel or pivot, a rotating grommet mechanism, a ball and socket mechanism, a temporary adhesive, a releasable latch, a clip, one or more buttons, a suction cup, and/or one or more straps allowing for rotational securement.

[0198] In certain embodiments, the coupling mechanism **1106**, **1108** may couple directly to a PED (not shown). For example, the loop portion **1108** may be constructed and arranged to be attached directly to the back of a PED. An adhesive designed to adhere to the back of the PED may be applied to the back of the loop portion **1108**. In other embodiments, the hook portion **1106** may include an adhesive to attach directly to the PED.

[0199] FIGS. **53-56** illustrate a holder **1200** for a PED (not shown) in a handheld configuration. The holder **1200** may include a case **1202** configured to receive, secure, and retain a PED, and a

sheath **1204**. The sheath **1204** may be constructed and arranged to releasably secure to the case **1202**. For example, the case **1202** may include one or more cleats **1206**, **1208** and the sheath **1204** may include one or more holes **1210** constructed and arranged to releasably attach the sheath **1204** to the cleats **1206**, **1208**.

[0200] FIG. **53** illustrates a back perspective view of the holder **1200** with the sheath **1204** detached from the case **1202**. FIG. **54** illustrates a back perspective view of the holder **1200** with the holes **1210** of the sheath **1204** attached to a pair of cleats **1208** in a first orientation. A user can insert a hand or other appendage in between the sheath **1204** and the case **1202** and the sheath **204**, such that the holder **1200** can be secured to the user. In FIG. **54**, the holder **1200** with the sheath **1204** in the first orientation is configured to be secured such that when the user's hand is positioned with fingers aligned horizontally across the user's body, the PED is oriented in a portrait orientation. Alternatively, if the user's hand is positioned with the fingers aligned vertically, the PED may be oriented in a landscape orientation. In other embodiments, the sheath **1204** can also function as a handle, such that a user can simply grasp the sheath **1204**. Accordingly, the sheath **1204**, in combination with the grasp of a user, can secure the case **1202** and PED disposed therein to a user.

[0201] The sheath **1204** can be detached from the first pair of cleats **1206**, as shown in FIG. **56**, rotated relative to the case **1202**, and attached to a second pair of cleats **1208** on the case **1202**, as shown in FIG. **54**. In this manner, the sheath **1204** may be rotatable to allow use of the PED in a portrait orientation or a landscape orientation. In certain embodiments, cleats **1206**, **1208** may be attached directly to the PED rather than to the case **1202**. Further, in certain embodiments, any number of cleats **1206**, **1208** may be included allowing for multiple viewing orientations including, or in addition to, a portrait orientation and/or a landscape orientation. Additional holes **1210** can be included on the sheath **1204** to allow for adjustable sizing and/or tension of the sheath **1204** to accommodate varying user hand sizes. Additionally, the inside of the sheath **1204** may be lined with a microfiber material and or a pad to provide comfortable use.

[0202] FIG. **55** is a top perspective view of the case **1202**, and a side view of the sheath **1204**. The sheath **1204** may include one or more notches **1212** that, in certain embodiments, may be shaped and configured to receive an end of the case **1202**. The sheath **1204** may be formed of a flexible material that can be bent into substantially a "U" shape, such that the end of the case **1202** can be inserted into notches **1212**.

[0203] FIGS. **57-58** illustrate a holder **1200** for a PED (not shown) in a stand configuration. As illustrated, the bottom edge of the sheath **1204** can be set on a table or other flat surface and can function as a stand for the PED when an end of the case **1202** is disposed in the notches **1212**. The sheath **1204** may also be configured to receive the PED at different orientations such that the user can insert the case **1202** and/or the PED **102** therein and view the display from a landscape orientation or, alternatively, a portrait orientation.

[0204] In certain embodiments, the sheath **1204** can include a pocket into which the user's hand or other appendage may be inserted. In other embodiments, the sheath **1204** may include an opening through which a user's hand can be inserted. The positioning of the cleats **1206**, **1208** may be adjustable (e.g., adjustable via a sliding mechanism), to adjust sizing and/or positioning of the sheath **1204** relative to the case **1202** and/or PED. In other embodiments, the cleats **1206**, **1208** may be detachable or configured to be disposed within (i.e., pushed into) the case **1202** when not in use.

[0205] FIGS. **59-62** illustrate a rotatable holder **1300** for a PED **102**. The holder **1300** may include a case **1302**, a hand grip **1304**, and a rotatable coupling member **1306** to rotatably attach the hand grip **1304** to the case **1302**. The case **1302** may be configured to receive, secure, and carry the PED **102**, and may include any combination of the various features and embodiments described in any of the cases described herein.

[0206] The case **1302** may further comprise one or more kickstands **1308** that may be constructed

and arranged to prop up the case **1302** in a viewing position. In certain embodiments, the kickstands **1308** may be recessed into the case **1302** when not in use, and may rotate out from the case **1302** to prop up the case **1302**, as illustrated in FIG. **61** and FIG. **62**. In this manner, the kickstands **1308** may allow the case **1302** to operate as a stand to support the PED **102** in a substantially upright and/or elevated position. A first kickstand **1308** may prop the case upright and/or elevated in a landscape orientation, as illustrated in FIG. **61**, and a second kickstand **1308** may prop the case upright and/or elevated in a portrait orientation, as illustrated in FIG. **62**.

[0207] The hand grip **1304** may include a knob or similar structure (e.g., a bulb, a handle, etc) that a user can easily grasp. The hand grip **1304** in combination with a user's grasp may secure the case relative to the user's hand. In the illustrated embodiments, the hand grip **1304** is substantially a half sphere. As can be appreciated, the hand grip **1304** may be formed in any suitable shape that can be easily grasped by a user. Hand grip **1304** may also include finger depressions designed to comfortably receive one or more of a user's fingers. In certain embodiments, the hand grip **1304** can be a mitt and/or similar glove-like or pocket-like structure coupled to the case **1302** by the rotatable coupling member **1306**. The mitt can be constructed and arranged with an opening to receive a hand of a user. The mitt may receive the hand of the user with the palm facing toward the back of the case **1302**, and may also be configured to receive the hand of the user with the palm facing away from the case **1302**. The mitt may further include a mounting plate to provide a rigid surface for attaching the mitt to the rotatable coupling member **1306**.

[0208] The rotatable coupling member **1306** may be configured to rotatably secure the hand grip **1304** to the case **1302**. In the illustrated embodiment, the coupling member **1306** may comprise a ratcheted swivel. The rotatable coupling member **1306** may allow the case **1302** to rotate relative to the hand grip **1304** without decoupling the case **1302** from the hand grip **1304** and without a user releasing the hand grip **1304**. The rotation allowed by the rotatable coupling member **1306** may be within a plane substantially parallel to a plane of the back surface of the case **1302** or a plane of the back surface of a PED **102** retained within the case **1302**. Accordingly, the rotation of the rotatable coupling member **1306** may facilitate rotation of the PED **102** between a variety of orientations including, for example, a portrait orientation and a landscape orientation. In certain embodiments, the rotatable coupling member **1306** may allow rotation up to at least ninety degrees, from portrait orientation to landscape orientation. The rotatable coupling member **1306** may also allow 360 degree rotation, such that the PED **102** can be rotated to any angle.

[0209] A ratcheting mechanism included within the rotatable coupling member **1306** may substantially secure the case **1302** relative to the hand grip **1304** at various increments of rotation. The ratcheting mechanism may be formed by a plurality of female detents interacting with one or more projecting members, such as spheres or half spheres that catch a detent as it passes during rotation. The rotatable coupling member **1306** may allow rotation of the case **1302** relative to the hand grip **1304** to substantially any desired degree, including points less than ninety degrees, thereby allowing the user to find a rotational orientation of the case **1302** that is comfortable. In certain embodiments, the rotatable coupling member **1306** may be configured such that the rotation may only lock into place at 90-degree intervals that correspond with the landscape and portrait orientations of the PED **102**.

[0210] FIGS. **63-65** illustrate a handheld holder **1400** for a PED **102**. The holder **1400** may include a case **1402**, and a hand pocket **1404** attached to the case **1402**. The case **1402** may be configured to receive, secure, and carry the PED **102**, and may include any combination of the various features and embodiments described in any of the cases described herein.

[0211] The hand pocket **1404** can be coupled to the back of the case **1402** and be configured to receive a hand of a user. In certain embodiments, the hand pocket **1404** can be constructed and arranged to receive a hand of a user such that a PED **102** inserted into the case **1402** is oriented in a portrait orientation and also constructed and arranged to receive the hand of the user such that the PED **102** is oriented in a landscape orientation. The hand pocket **1404** may be stitched to the back

of the case **1402**, or otherwise secured using any appropriate securement method or device, including but not limited to an adhesive, hooks and loops, buttons, one or more zippers, and/or clamps. The hand pocket **1404** may also be integrated into the case **1402**.

[0212] The hand pocket **1404** may include a first opening **1406** to receive a hand of a user and thereby secure the PED **102** relative to the hand of the user. The PED **102** may be secured relative to the hand of the user such that when the user raises the hand substantially near the abdomen or chest, the PED **102** may be oriented in a portrait orientation. In certain embodiments, the user's hand may be received into the hand pocket **1404** with the palm facing toward the back of the PED **102** or, alternatively, with the palm facing away from the PED **102**.

[0213] The hand pocket **1404** may further include a second opening **1408** to receive the hand of the user and thereby secure the PED **102** relative to the hand of the user such that the PED **102** is oriented in a landscape orientation. In such embodiments, the user may remove a hand from the first opening **1406** and insert the hand into the second opening **1408** to change the orientation of the PED **102**. In this manner the case **1402** is rotatable at least ninety degrees and allows operability of the PED **102** in either a portrait or a landscape orientation.

[0214] In some embodiments, the holder **1400** may include a pocket **1404** that further includes a third opening **1410** opposite the first opening **1406** and a fourth opening **1412** opposite the second opening **1408**. Using these openings **1406**, **1408**, **1410**, and **1412**, a hand can be inserted into the hand pocket **1404** from any of four directions separated by ninety degrees, thus allowing orientation of the PED **102** in either of two possible landscape orientations (e.g., a first landscape orientation and then a second landscape orientation at 180 degrees from the first) and in either of two possible portrait orientations (e.g., a first portrait orientation and then a second at 180 degrees from the first). Furthermore, the fingers of a hand inserted into the third opening **1410** may extend partially out of the first opening **1406**, as illustrated in FIG. **64**. Similarly, the fingers of a hand inserted into the second opening **1408** may extend partially out of the fourth opening **1412**.

[0215] As illustrated in FIG. **65**, the hand pocket **1404** may be connected to the PED **102** and/or case **1402** via a rotatable coupling mechanism **1414**, such as a grommet or any other rotatable connection and/or mechanism described herein. In certain embodiments, the pocket **1404** may comprise a slightly rigid or reinforced side configured to be positioned adjacent to the PED **102** and/or the case **1402** and to be coupled to the rotatable coupling mechanism **1414**.

[0216] FIGS. **66-67** illustrate a handheld holder **1500** for a PED (not shown). The holder **1500** may include a case **1502** and one or more hand pockets **1504**, **1506** coupled to the case **1502**. The case **1502** may be configured to receive, secure, and carry the PED, and may include any combination of the various features and embodiments described in any of the cases described herein.

[0217] One hand pocket **1506** may be oriented to receive a hand of a user and thereby secure the holder such that a PED secured in the case **1502** is oriented in a portrait orientation. Another hand pocket **1504** may be oriented to receive the hand of the user and thereby secure the holder such that a PED secured in the case **1502** is oriented in a landscape orientation. The user can insert the hand into either of the hand pockets **1504**, **1506**, depending on the desired orientation of the PED. In this manner, the case **1502** is rotatable at least ninety degrees and allows operability of the PED in either a portrait or a landscape orientation. In another embodiment, the holder **1500** may comprise additional hand pockets **1504**, **1506** to allow additional degrees of rotation.

[0218] The hand pockets **1504**, **1506** may be stitched to the back of the case **1502**, or otherwise be secured using any appropriate securement method or device, including but not limited to an adhesive, hook and loop mechanisms, buttons, one or more zippers, and/or clamps. The hand pockets **1504**, **1506** may also be integrated into the case **1502**. In certain embodiments, the hand pockets **1504**, **1506** may be movable to one or more positions on the back of the case **1502**. For example, a back side of the case **1502** may include a loop portion of a hook and loop mechanism, and the hand pockets **1504**, **1506** may be attached anywhere on the backside of the case **1502** using a hook portion disposed thereon. In this manner, the hand pockets **1504**, **1506** may be positioned on

the case **1502** to allow for a variety of viewing orientations.

[0219] FIGS. **68-69** illustrate a case **1600** for a PED (not shown). The case **1600** may be configured to receive, secure, and carry the PED, and may include any combination of the various features and embodiments described in any of the cases described herein. As illustrated, the case may include one or more kickstands **1604** configured to allow the case **1600** to function as a stand depending on the orientation of the kickstands **1604** (e.g., depending on whether kickstands are deployed). In certain embodiments, the kickstands **1604** may be recessed into the case **1600** when not in use to prop the case **1600** in an upright and/or elevated position, and may rotate out from the case **1600** for use, as illustrated. The kickstands **1604** may allow the case to operate as a stand to support a PED in a substantially upright and/or elevated position. A first kickstand **1604** may prop the case **1600** upright and/or elevated in a landscape orientation, as illustrated in FIG. **68**, and a second kickstand **1604** may prop the case **1600** upright and/or elevated in a portrait orientation, as illustrated in FIG. **69**.

[0220] The case **1600** may also include a cover **1602** configured to be positioned over a PED inserted into the case **1600** and to substantially enclose and/or protect the PED. In certain embodiments, the cover **1602** may snap into the case **1600**, thereby enclosing a PED disposed therein. In other embodiments, the cover **1602** may be strapped or fastened using any other mechanical means into the case **1600**. In certain embodiments, the cover **1602** can be used to protect a PED disposed within the case **1600** when the PED is not in use. In other embodiments, the cover **1602** may comprise a transparent window through which a user can view and/or manipulate the PED, and thus the cover **1602** can remain positioned over the PED, both during use and when not in use. In certain embodiments, a window included in the cover **1602** may be permanently open or may alternatively be selectively openable.

[0221] FIG. **70** illustrates a handheld holder **1700** for a PED (not shown). The handheld holder **1700** may comprise a case **1702** and a hand pocket **1704** coupled to the case **1702** via a rotatable coupling mechanism **1706**. In certain embodiments, the rotatable coupling mechanism **1706** may be a grommet or any other rotatable connection and/or mechanism described herein, and may be coupled directly to a PED rather than the case **1702**. The case **1702** may be configured to receive, secure, and carry the PED, and may include any combination of the various features and embodiments described in any of the cases described herein. Further, the hand pocket **1704** may be a pocket, a strap, a pouch, a knob, a handle, and or any interface allowing a user's hand or other appendage to grasp or otherwise be secured into the hand pocket **1704**.

[0222] The rotatable coupling mechanism **1706** may allow a PED disposed in the case **1702** to be viewed in a variety of viewing orientations relative to the hand pocket **1704**. For example, in certain embodiments, a user may secure the hand pocket **1704** in a particular position (e.g., by securing a hand in the hand pocket **1704** or the like), and rotate the case **1702** in a variety of orientations relative to the hand pocket **1704** using the rotatable coupling mechanism **1706**. In certain embodiments, the rotatable coupling mechanism **1706** may be configured to have one or more locking positions where the rotatable coupling mechanism **1706** requires a higher degree of rotational resistance to move the rotatable coupling mechanism from the non-locking positions. For example, the rotatable coupling mechanism **1706** may including locking positions where the case **1702** relative to the hand pocket **1704** is in a portrait orientation and a landscape orientation.

[0223] FIGS. **71-73** illustrate a rotatable coupling mechanism **1706**. The rotatable coupling mechanism **1706** may be included in any of the case designs detailed herein and be used in such designs to change the orientation of a PED to one or more desired orientations (e.g., landscape and/or portrait). The rotatable coupling mechanism **1706** may be substantially any cylindrical shape (e.g., a long shaft, a short cylinder similar to a hockey puck, etc.) and may comprise two complementary halves **1708**, **1710** configured to rotate relative to each other and interact so as to create one or more locking positions. The complementary surfaces of the halves **1708**, **1710** may comprise one or more protrusions **1712** and one or more depressions **1714** to implement a locking

position. The protrusions **1712** of a first half **1708** may complement and conform to the depressions **1714** of a second half **1710**, as illustrated in FIG. 72. Similarly, the protrusions **1712** of the second half **1710** may complement and conform to the depressions **1714** of the first half **1708**. As the first half **1708** rotates relative to the second half **1710**, the protrusions **1712** of the first half **1708** may rotate between non-locking positions (i.e., where the protrusions **1712** of the first half **1708** abut the protrusions **1712** of the second half **1710**) and locking positions (i.e., where the protrusions **1712** of the first half **1708** abut the depressions **1714** of the second half **1710**). The protrusions **1712** and depressions **1714** may alternate as illustrated and may be any functionally appropriate shape including, a wave shape, a set of complementary teeth, and the like.

[0224] In certain embodiments, the protrusions **1712** may have a rounded shape and be configured such that a first protrusion **1712** on a first half **1708** allows a second protrusion **1712** on the opposing second half **1710** to smoothly rotate over and past the first protrusion as the halves **1708**, **1710** rotate relative to one another. Similarly, the depressions **1714** may have a rounded shape. Moreover, the transition from a protrusion **1712** to a depression **1714** may be seamless and continuous to form a gentle rounded surface as illustrated. Accordingly, the halves **1708**, **1710** can easily be rotated relative to one another, and thereby transitioned between locking positions, while the halves **1708**, **1710** are in abutment to one another and without being separated.

[0225] In other embodiments, the protrusions **1712** may be jagged without a rounded shape. For example, the protrusions **1712** may comprise complementary teeth. In some embodiments, the teeth may be triangular in shape, alternating between protrusions **1712** and depressions **1714**. In certain embodiments, the halves **1708**, **1710** may need to be pulled apart and separated before rotation can occur. In other embodiments, the transition from protrusion **1712** to depression **1714** may be more pronounced and/or non-continuous, such that there is a separation between each protrusion **1712** and depression **1714**.

[0226] In the illustrated embodiments, each half **1708**, **1710** comprises four protrusions **1712** and four depressions **1714**. Accordingly, the rotatable coupling mechanism **1706** comprises four locking positions. The four locking positions may each correspond to ninety degrees of rotation. As can be appreciated, additional protrusions **1712** and depressions **1714** may be provided so as to allow additional locking positions at smaller degrees of rotation. Moreover, fewer protrusions **1712** and depressions **1714** may be provided as well to provide fewer locking positions.

[0227] The rotatable coupling mechanism **1706** may further comprise a connecting member **1716**, such as a rod or elastic piece, configured as an axis about which the halves **1708**, **1710** rotate. The connecting member **1716** may also secure the halves **1708**, **1710** relative to one another. In some embodiments, the connecting member **1716** may include one or more biasing members configured to urge the first half **1708** and second half **1710** together. For example, the connecting member **1716** may pass through the two halves **1708**, **1710** and be spring-loaded with springs **1718** on the outside of the two halves **1708**, **1710** to push the two halves **1708**, **1710** together. Alternatively, the connecting member **1716** itself may comprise a biasing member, such as a spring **1718** or an elastic material, that may provide a biasing force, as illustrated in FIG. 73. The biasing force may be provided to urge the halves **1708**, **1710** toward one another. The biasing force may also urge the rotatable coupling mechanism **1706** toward a locking position (i.e., by urging the protrusions **1712** of the first half **1708** toward a position abutting the depressions **1714** of the second half **1710** and vice versa). In other embodiments, an external force such as, for example, gravity may provide a biasing force to urge the halves **1708**, **1710** toward one another.

[0228] FIGS. 74-77 illustrate a rotatable case **1800** for a PED **102**. The case **1800** may include a holder **1802** configured to receive, secure, retain, and carry the PED **102**, and may include any combination of the various features and embodiments described in any of the cases and/or holders described herein. As illustrated, the holder **1802** may be configured to retain the PED **102** by mechanically securing the PED **102** at its corners. In certain embodiments, the holder **1802** may retain the PED **102** using a compression and/or snap fit mechanism.

[0229] The case **1800** may further include a cover **1804**, **1806** comprising a base portion **1804** and a support portion **1806**. The base portion **1804** and the support portion **1806** may be coupled at a fold **1808** allowing for the base portion **1804** to hinge with respect to the support portion **1806**. In certain embodiments, the base portion **1804** and the support portion **1806** may be formed integrally and the fold **1808** may be formed as part of the base portion **1804** and the support portion **1806**. In other embodiments, the base portion **1804**, the support portion **1806**, and the fold **1808** may be separate components. In certain embodiments, the holder **1802** and/or the cover **1804** may provide protection to an enclosed PED **102**. For example, the holder **1802**, the base portion **1804**, and/or the support portion **1806** may be reinforced with padding, metal, plastic, cardboard, rubber, and/or other materials or any combination thereof.

[0230] In certain embodiments, the fold **1808** may include various folds, bends, and/or curvatures in material to obtain desirable resistance and/or resilience characteristics. For the example, the fold **1808** may be configured to function as a bi-stable, tri-stable, or N-stable fold, allowing a user to selectively vary the relative angle between the base portion **1804** and the support portion **1806** into one or more predetermined angles. In some embodiments utilizing an N-stable fold, the support portion **1806** may effectively “snap” into one or more predetermined positions relative to the base portion **1804**.

[0231] The base portion **1804** may be coupled to a vertical support **1810** via a hinge **1812**. In certain embodiments, the vertical support **1810** may be configured to support in part the holder **1802** in an upright and/or elevated position allowing for viewing of the display **104** of the PED **102**. The vertical support **1810** may be coupled to the holder **1802** via a rotational mechanism **1814** allowing for variable rotation of the holder **1802** relative to the vertical support **1810**. For example, as illustrated in FIG. 77, the rotational mechanism **1814** may include a rotational grommet secured to the vertical support **1810** and the holder **1802** allowing for variable rotation of the holder **1802** relative to the vertical support **1810**. In other embodiments, the rotational mechanism **1814** may include a ratcheting swivel or pivot, a ball and socket mechanism, a temporary adhesive, a releasable latch, a clip, one or more buttons, a suction cup, and/or one or more straps allowing for rotational securement. In certain embodiments, the rotational mechanism **1814** may snap into certain specific rotational orientations (e.g., portrait orientation, as illustrated in FIG. 75, and/or landscape orientation, as illustrated in FIG. 74) and require rotational force to move to a different specific orientation. In alternative embodiments, the rotation mechanism **1814** may not snap into specific orientations but may allow for rotational articulation in any number of orientations. Further, in certain embodiments, the vertical support **1810** may be coupled to the holder **1802** via a non-rotatable connection including, for example, a fixed and/or hinged mechanism.

[0232] The vertical support **1810** may be configured to allow for its length to be adjusted using a sliding track or similar adjustable mechanism. In some embodiments, by adjusting the length of the vertical support **1810**, the relative distance between the base portion **1804** and the holder **1802** may be adjusted. In certain embodiments, the length of the vertical support **1810** may be configured to be adjusted to one or more predetermined positions via a selective locking mechanism or the like. In other embodiments, the vertical support **1810** may have a fixed length.

[0233] As illustrated in FIG. 77, the back of the vertical support **1810** may include one or more channels **1816**. In some embodiments, the channels may be configured to receive an edge of the support portion **1806**. To configure the case **1800** to support the PED **102** in an upright and/or elevated position, the base portion **1804** may be rotated relative to the vertical support **1810** about the hinge **1812** and rested on a work surface. The angle of the support portion **1806** may be adjusted relative to the base portion **1804** via the fold **1808**, thereby adjusting a viewing angle of the PED **102** included in the holder **1802**. When a desired angle is achieved, an end of the support portion **1804** may be positioned in one of the channels **1816**, allowing for the desired viewing angle to be sustained by the case **1800**. In some embodiments, the end of the support portion **1806** may be secured in the channels **1816** via a compression fit. In other embodiments, a selective

securement mechanism may be used to secure the end of the support portion **1806** in the channels **1816** that may include a magnetic connection, a snap, a button, a clip, or the like.

[0234] When the PED **102** is not in use, the case **1800** may be reconfigured by a user into a stowage configuration, as illustrated in FIG. **76**. To reconfigure the case **1800** in a stowage configuration, the base portion **1804** and the support portion **1806** may be articulated around the hinge **1812** so as to cover the display **104** of the PED **102**. In such a configuration, the fold **1808** may be adjusted to allow the base portion **1804** and the support portion **1806** to be substantially coplanar. In certain embodiments, reconfiguration of the case **1800** in a stowage configuration may require that the length of the vertical support **1810** be adjusted using a sliding track mechanism or the like. In some embodiments, the base portion **1804** and the support portion **1806** may be secured to the holder **1802** and/or the PED **102** in the stowage configuration via a magnetic connection, one or more releasable clips, straps, and/or other locking mechanisms allowing for the case **1800** to be selectively locked into a stowage configuration and selectively released from the stowage configuration.

[0235] FIGS. **78-81** illustrate a support **1900** for a PED **102**. The support **1900** may include a holder **1902**, **1904** configured to receive, secure, retain, and carry the PED **102**, and may include any combination of the various features and embodiments described in any of the cases and/or holders described herein. As illustrated, the holder **1902**, **1904** may be configured to retain the PED **102** by mechanically securing the PED **102** using a compression fit mechanism or the like. In certain embodiments, the holder **1902**, **1904** may include a main portion **1902** and a selectively removable top portion **1904**. A PED **102** may be disposed within the main portion **1902** when the top portion **1904** is removed and securely locked within the main portion **1902** when the top portion **1904** is securely coupled to the main portion **1902** using a selective latching mechanism **1906** or the like. In some embodiments, the main portion **1902** and the top portion **1904** may be aligned using one or more ribs and/or channels or similar alignment mechanism.

[0236] In certain embodiments, the holder **1902**, **1904** may further comprise one or more kickstands **1908** that may be configured and arranged to prop up the holder **1902**, **1904** in a viewing position. The kickstand **1908** may be recessed into the holder **1902**, **1904** when not in use, as illustrated in FIG. **78** and FIG. **79**, and may be rotated out from the holder **1902**, **1904** via a hinge **1910** to prop up the holder **1902**, **1904**, as illustrated in FIG. **80** and FIG. **81**. In this manner, the kickstand **1908** may allow the support **1900** to operate as a stand to support the PED **102** disposed in the holder **1902**, **1904** in a substantially upright and/or elevated position. In certain embodiments, by adjusting the angle of the kickstand **1908** relative to the holder **1902**, **1904**, a viewing angle of a PED **102** disposed within the support **1900** may be adjusted. For example, by increasing the degree to which the kickstand **1908** is rotated out from the holder **1902**, **1904** via the hinge **1910**, the PED **102** may be viewed at a less upright and/or elevated angle. Similarly, by decreasing the degree to which the kickstand **1908** is rotated out from the holder **1902**, **1904**, the PED **102** may be viewed at a more upright and/or elevated angle. In certain embodiments, the hinge **1910** may be configured to allow the kickstand **1908** to rotate out from the holder **1902**, **1904** at one or more predetermined angles using, for example, a ratcheting mechanism or the like.

[0237] The length of the kickstand **1908** may be adjusted using a sliding and/or ratcheting mechanism **1912**. In certain embodiments, by adjusting the length of the kickstand **1908**, the relative viewing angle of the PED **102** disposed within the support **1900** may be adjusted. For example, by lengthening the kickstand **1908**, the PED **102** may be viewed at a more upright and/or elevated angle. Similarly, by shortening the kickstand **1908**, the PED **102** may be viewed at a less upright and/or elevated angle. In certain embodiments, the length of the kickstand **1908** may be configured to be adjusted to one or more predetermined positions via a selective locking mechanism **1914** or the like. In alternative embodiments, the kickstand **1908** may have a fixed length.

[0238] A rest **1916** may be disposed at an end of the kickstand **1908** and be configured to rest on a

working surface when the support **1900** is in use. In certain embodiments, the rest **1916** may include one or more edges configured to be positioned parallel to a working surface when the support **1900** is oriented in one or more orientations. For example, as illustrated in FIG. **80**, the rest **1916** may include an edge configured to sit parallel to a working surface when the PED **102** is viewed in a portrait configuration. Similarly, as illustrated in FIG. **81**, the rest **1916** may include an edge configured to sit parallel to a working surface when the PED **102** is viewed in a landscape orientation. In this manner, by lifting and rotating the support **1900**, a PED **102** disposed therein may be viewed in a landscape and/or a portrait orientation. In certain embodiments, the rest **1916** may comprise a material configured to prevent the rest **1916** from easily sliding along the work surface (e.g., rubber or the like).

[0239] FIGS. **82-84** illustrate a rotatable support **2000** for a PED **102**. The support **2000** may include a holder **2002**, **2004** configured to receive, secure, retain, and carry the PED **102**, and may include any combination of the various features and embodiments described in any of the cases and/or holders described herein. As illustrated, the holder **2002**, **2004** may be configured to retain the PED **102** by mechanically securing the PED **102** using a compression fit mechanism or the like. In certain embodiments, the holder **2002**, **2004** may include a main portion **2002** and a selectively removable top portion **2004**. A PED **102** may be disposed within the main portion **2002** when the top portion **2004** is removed and securely locked within the main portion **2002** when the top portion **2004** is securely coupled to the main portion **2002** using a selective latching mechanism or the like. In certain embodiments, a depression **2006** integrated into the main portion **2002** and/or the top portion **2004** may be utilized by a user to aid in removing the top portion **2004** from the main portion **2002**. In some embodiments, the main portion **2002** and the top portion **2004** may be aligned using one or more ribs and/or channels or a similar alignment mechanism.

[0240] The holder **2002**, **2004** may define a window allowing for a display **104** of the PED **102** to be viewed by a user. Further, the holder **2002**, **2004** may include one or more access windows **2008** allowing for PED **102** accessories (e.g., cameras) and/or interfaces (e.g., buttons, switches, knobs, etc.) to be accessed through the holder **2002**, **2004**.

[0241] The holder **2002**, **2004** may further comprise one or more kickstands **2010** that may be configured and arranged to prop up the holder **2002**, **2004** in a viewing position. The kickstand **2010** may be recessed into the holder **2002**, **2004** when not in use, as illustrated in FIG. **82**, and may be rotated out from the holder **2002**, **2004** via a hinge **2012** to prop up the holder **2002**, **2004**, as illustrated in FIG. **83**. In this manner, the kickstand **2010** may allow the support **2000** to operate as a stand to support the PED **102** disposed in the holder **2002**, **2004** in a substantially upright and/or elevated position. In certain embodiments, by adjusting the relative angle of the kickstand **2010** relative to the holder **2002**, **2004**, a viewing angle of a PED **102** disposed within the support **2000** may be adjusted. For example, by increasing the degree to which the kickstand **2010** is rotated out from the holder **2002**, **2004** via the hinge **2012**, the PED **102** may be viewed at a less upright and/or elevated angle when a rest **2014** included on the end of the kickstand **2010** is placed on a working surface. Similarly, by decreasing the degree to which the kickstand **2010** is rotated out from the holder **2002**, **2004**, the PED **102** may be viewed at a more upright and/or elevated angle when a rest **2014** included on the end of the kickstand **2010** is placed on a working surface. In some embodiments, the hinge **2012** may be configured to allow the kickstand **2010** to rotate out from the holder **2002**, **2004** at one or more predetermined angles using, for example, a ratcheting mechanism or the like. In certain embodiments, the rest **2014** may comprise a material configured to prevent the rest **2014** from easily sliding along the work surface (e.g., rubber or the like).

[0242] The length of the kickstand **2010** may be adjusted using a sliding and/or ratcheting mechanism **2016**. In certain embodiments, by adjusting the length of the kickstand **2010**, the relative viewing angle of the PED **102** disposed within the support **2000** may be adjusted. For example, by lengthening the kickstand **2010**, the PED **102** may be viewed at a more upright and/or elevated angle. Similarly, by shortening the kickstand **2010**, the PED **102** may be viewed at a less

upright and/or elevated angle. In certain embodiments, the length of the kickstand **2010** may be configured to be adjusted to one or more predetermined positions via a selective locking mechanism or the like. In alternative embodiments, the kickstand **2010** may have a fixed length. [0243] In certain embodiments, the kickstand **2010** may be coupled to the holder **2002**, **2004** via a rotational mechanism **2018**. In certain embodiments, the rotational mechanism **2018** may include a rotational grommet secured to the hinge **2012** and the kickstand **2010** allowing for variable rotation of the kickstand **2010** relative to the holder **2002**, **2004**. In other embodiments, the rotational mechanism **2018** may include a ratcheting swivel or pivot, a ball and socket mechanism, a temporary adhesive, a releasable latch, a clip, one or more buttons, a suction cup, and/or one or more straps allowing for rotational securement. In certain embodiments, the rotational mechanism **2018** may snap into certain specific rotational orientations (e.g., portrait orientation and/or landscape orientation) and require rotational force to move to a different specific orientation. In alternative embodiments, the rotation mechanism **2018** may not snap into specific orientations but may allow for rotational articulation in any number of orientations. Further, in certain embodiments, the kickstand **2010** may be coupled to the holder **2002**, **2004** via a non-rotatable connection including, for example, a fixed and/or hinged mechanism.

[0244] In some embodiments, the support **2000** may not include a holder **2002**, **2004**, and the kickstand **2010** may be coupled to the PED **102** directly or via a rotation mechanism **2018**. In certain embodiments, the kickstand **2010** and or rotation mechanism **2018** may be coupled to the PED **102** using one or more straps, buckles, clips, adhesives, and/or other mechanical structures integrated into the PED **102** and/or the kickstand **2010** and/or rotation mechanism **2018**.

[0245] FIGS. **85-86** illustrate a handheld holder **2100** for a PED **102**. The handheld holder **2100** may include a case **2102** configured to receive, secure, retain, and carry the PED **102**, and may include any combination of the various features and embodiments described in any of the cases and/or holders described herein. As illustrated, the case **2102** may be configured to retain the PED **102** by mechanically securing the PED **102** about an outer periphery thereof. In certain embodiments, the case **2102** may retain the PED **102** using a compression and/or snap fit mechanism.

[0246] A hand grip **2104** may be included on a back of the handheld holder **2100**. In certain embodiments, the hand grip **2104** may be mounted to a rotational mechanism **2110** coupled to the back of the case **2102**. The hand grip **2104** may include a center hub **2108** and one or more straps **2106** extending outward therefrom and coupled to an outer periphery of the rotational mechanism **2110**. A user may be able to slip a part of an appendage (e.g., a hand or forearm as illustrated in FIG. **85**) between the rotational mechanism **2110** and the straps **2106** to secure the case **2102** to the user. In certain embodiments, the hand grip **2104** may be formed integrally with the rotational mechanism **2110**. In other embodiments, the hand grip **2104** or a portion thereof (e.g., the straps **2106**) may pass through and/or wrap around at least a portion of the rotational mechanism **2110**.

[0247] The center hub **2108** may include a mechanism such that when it is rotated, the length of the one or more straps **2106** extending outward therefrom are adjusted. For example, when the center hub **2108** is rotated in a particular direction, the length of the one or more straps **2106** may be shortened. Similarly, when the center hub **2108** is rotated in a different direction, the length of the one or more straps may be increased. By allowing for adjustment of the length of the one or more straps **2106**, the hand grip **2104** may be sized so as to be secured to a user's appendage (e.g., a hand or forearm) regardless of size.

[0248] The rotational mechanism **2110** may include a rotating grommet, a ratcheting swivel or pivot, a ball and socket mechanism, a temporary adhesive, a releasable latch, a clip, one or more buttons, a suction cup, and/or one or more straps allowing for rotational securement of the hand grip **2104** to the case **2102**. The inside of the strap **2106** and/or the rotational mechanism **2110** may be lined at least in part with a pad and/or soft material (e.g., microfiber) to provide comfortable use. In certain embodiments, the rotational mechanism **2110** may be a circular shape, as illustrated, to

comfortably conform to the palm of a user's hand. In other embodiments, the rotational mechanism **2110** may comprise any suitable and/or ergonomic shape.

[0249] When a user is wearing the rotatable holder **2100** by securing the hand grip **2104** to an appendage, the user may change the viewing orientation of the PED **102** disposed in the case **2102** by rotating the case **2102** around the rotational mechanism **2110** while securing the relative position of the hand grip **2104** in a fixed position. For example, a user may orient the rotational mechanism **2110** such that the PED **102** is viewed in a portrait orientation, as illustrated in FIG. **85**. By applying rotational force to the PED **102** and/or the case **2102**, the case **2102** may be rotated around the rotational mechanism **2110** and viewed in a different orientation including, for example, a landscape orientation. In certain embodiments, the rotational mechanism **2110** may be configured to effectively snap into one or more predetermined orientations including, for example, a portrait orientation and/or a landscape orientation.

[0250] In some embodiments, the holder **2100** may not include a case **2102** and the hand grip **2104** may be coupled to the PED **102** directly or via a rotation mechanism **2110**. In certain embodiments, the hand grip **2104** and/or rotation mechanism **2110** may be coupled to the PED **102** using one or more straps, buckles, clips, adhesives, and/or other mechanical structures integrated into the PED **102** and/or the hand grip **2104** and/or the rotation mechanism **2110**.

[0251] FIGS. **87-89** illustrate a support **2200** for a PED **102**. The support **2200** may include a case **2202** configured to receive, secure, retain, and carry the PED **102**, and may include any combination of the various features and embodiments described in any of the cases and/or holders described herein. As illustrated, the case **2202** may be configured to retain the PED **102** by mechanically securing the PED **102** using a compression fit mechanism or the like. In certain embodiments, the PED **102** may be secured within the case **2202** by one or more securement clips **2204** located on an end of the case **2202** configured to receive the PED **102**, as illustrated in FIG. **89**.

[0252] In some embodiments, the case **2202** may define a window allowing a user to view a display **104** of the PED **102**. Further, the case **2202** may include one or more areas exposing the PED **102**. In certain embodiments, these areas may aid in removing the PED **102** from the case **2202**.

[0253] The support **2200** may further comprise one or more kickstands **2206** coupled to the case **2202** that may be configured and arranged to prop up the support **2200** in a viewing position. In certain embodiments, the kickstand **2206** may include any combination of the various features and embodiments described in any of the kickstands described herein. For example, the kickstand **2206** may be rotationally coupled to the case **2202** using a rotational mechanism similar to the rotational mechanism **2018** illustrated in FIGS. **82-84**. In such embodiments, the viewing orientation (e.g., portrait and/or landscape orientation) of the PED **102** disposed within the support **2200** may be adjusted by rotating the kickstand **2206** relative to the case **2202**. Further, the kickstand **2206** may be adjustable similar to the kickstand **2010** illustrated in FIGS. **82-84**.

[0254] In certain embodiments, the case **2202** may define a storage region **2208** configured to secure and retain (i.e., store) one or more accessories **2210** associated with the PED **102** to the case **2202**. In some embodiments, the one or more accessories **2210** may comprise any PED **102** interface (e.g., a keyboard, a mouse, headphones, and the like) or accessory (e.g., memory devices, cleaning solution, and the like). In certain embodiments, the one or more accessories **2210** may be secured and retained within the storage region **2208** mechanically using a compression fit mechanism or the like. In certain other embodiments, the one or more accessories may be secured within the storage region **2208** using one or more releasable clips, straps, or other locking features that allow for the accessories **2210** to be selectively locked into the storage region **2208** and selectively released from the storage region **2208**.

[0255] FIGS. **90-91** illustrates a rotatable case **2300** for a PED **102** oriented in a landscape configuration. In certain embodiments, the rotatable case **2300** may include a holder (not shown)

configured to receive, secure, retain, and carry the PED **102**, and may include any combination of the various features and embodiments described in any of the cases and/or holders described herein. In other embodiments, as illustrated, the rotatable case **2300** may couple directly to the PED **102**.

[0256] The rotatable case **2300** may include one or more horizontal supports **2302** extending from a rotational hub **2304** and coupled to an outer edge of the PED **102** via horizontal support clips **2306**. In some embodiments, the horizontal support clips **2306** may be coupled to the outer edge of the PED **102** using a compression fit. In alternative embodiments, the horizontal support clips **2306** may be secured to the outer edge of the PED **102** using releasable clips, straps, or any other selectively locking mechanism. In certain embodiments, the length of the horizontal supports **2302** may be adjusted so that the horizontal support clips **2306** fit securely around the outer edge of the PED **102**. In this manner, the horizontal supports **2302** may be adjusted to secure PEDs **102** having varied dimensions.

[0257] In certain embodiments, the rotational hub **2304** may include a rotational mechanism configured to allow the horizontal supports **2302** to rotate relative to one or more vertical supports **2308**. The rotational mechanism may include a rotating grommet, a ratcheting swivel or pivot, a ball and socket mechanism, a temporary adhesive, a releasable latch, a clip, one or more buttons, a suction cup, and/or one or more straps allowing for rotational securement of the horizontal supports **2302** to the vertical supports **2308**.

[0258] The vertical supports **2308** may be coupled to an outer edge of the PED **102** via vertical support clips **2310**. In some embodiments, the vertical support clips **2310** may be coupled to the outer edge of the PED **102** using a compression fit. In alternative embodiments, the vertical support clips **2310** may be secured to the outer edge of the PED **102** using releasable clips, straps, or any other selectively locking mechanism. In certain embodiments, the length of the vertical supports **2308** may be adjusted so that the vertical support clips **2310** fit securely around the outer edge of the PED **102**. In this manner, the vertical supports **2308** may be adjusted to secure PEDs **102** having varied dimensions.

[0259] Each E of the horizontal support clips **2306** may be coupled to the ends of PED supports **2312**. In certain embodiments, the horizontal support clips **2306** may be rotatably coupled to the ends of PED supports **2312** such that the PED supports **2312** may rotate in one or more directions relative to the horizontal support clips **2306**. In this manner, the PED supports **2312** may be utilized to support the PED **102** when the PED **102** is propped up in an upright and/or elevated viewing position. In certain embodiments, the lengths of the PED supports **2312** may be adjustable.

[0260] The other ends of the PED supports **2312** may be coupled to hinges **2314** configured to allow the PED supports **2312** to rotate in one or more directions relative to the hinges **2314**. The hinges **2314** may be in turn rigidly coupled to a base **2316**. During use of the rotatable case **2300**, the base **2316** may be placed on a working surface. The PED **102** may be raised and oriented in a viewing position by placing a bottom edge of the PED **102** on a top surface of the base **2316**, as illustrated in FIG. **90**. In such a configuration, the PED **102** may be supported in part by PED supports **2312** oriented at an appropriate angle relative to the PED **102** and/or base **2316** via the hinges **2314** and/or the horizontal support clips **2306**. In some embodiments, the viewing angle of the PED **102** may be adjusted by changing the relative angle of the PED supports **2312** relative to the PED **102** and/or base **2316**. In certain embodiments, the PED supports **2312** may be configured to support the PED **102** at one or more predefined viewing angles using a ratcheting or similar mechanism included in the hinges **2314** and/or the horizontal support clips **2306**.

[0261] In certain embodiments, the bottom edge of the PED **102** may be positioned in one or more channels (not shown) included on the top surface of the base **2316** that may be similar to the channels **116** illustrated in FIGS. **1-2**. In other embodiments, the bottom edge of the PED **102** may be rested on a material included on the top surface of the base **2316** designed to prevent the bottom edge of the PED **102** from easily sliding along the surface (e.g., rubber, suede, or the like).

[0262] In certain embodiments, when the PED **102** is in an upright and/or elevated position, the orientation of the PED **102** may be adjusted by rotating the vertical supports **2308** coupled to the PED **102** relative to the horizontal supports **2302** about the rotational hub **2304**. For example, the vertical supports **2308** may be rotated about the rotational hub **2304** into a position where the vertical supports **2308** are perpendicular to the horizontal supports **2302** which may correspond to a landscape orientation for the PED **102**, as illustrated in FIG. **90**. Similarly, the vertical supports **2308** may be rotated about the rotational hub **2304** into a position where the vertical supports **2308** are parallel to the horizontal supports **2302** which may correspond to a portrait orientation for the PED **102**.

[0263] In some embodiments, the base **2316** may include one or more integrated interfaces **2318** configured to interface with the PED **102**. For example, as illustrated in FIG. **90**, the base **2316** may include a keyboard. In other embodiments, the interfaces **2318** may include a touch pad, a speaker, or any other interface device capable of being integrated into the base **2316**.

[0264] When the PED **102** is not in use, the rotatable case **2300** may be reconfigured by a user into a stowage configuration, as illustrated in FIG. **91**. To reconfigure the rotatable case **2300** in a stowage configuration, the PED **102** may be articulated around the PED supports **2312**, hinges **2314**, and/or the horizontal support clips **2306** so as to cover the display **104** of the PED **102** with the top surface of the base **2316**. In such a configuration, interfaces **2318** disposed on the top surface of the base **2316** may also be protected from external damage. In certain embodiments, reconfiguration of the case **2300** in a stowage configuration may require that the length of the PED supports **2312** be adjusted. In some embodiments, the base **2316** may be secured to the PED **102** in the stowage configuration via a magnetic connection, one or more releasable clips, straps, and/or other locking mechanism allowing for the rotatable case **2300** to be selectively locked into a stowage configuration and selectively release from the stowage configuration.

[0265] FIGS. **92-95** illustrate a rotatable case **2400** for a PED **102** including an integrated keyboard **2406**. In certain embodiments, the rotatable case **2400** may include a holder (not shown) configured to receive, secure, retain, and carry the PED **102**, and may include any combination of the various features and embodiments described in any of the cases and/or holders described herein. In other embodiments, as illustrated, the rotatable case **2400** may couple directly to the PED **102**.

[0266] The rotatable case **2400** may include a holder **2402** extending from a rotational hub **2408** and coupled to the outer edges of the PED **102**. In some embodiments, the holder **2402** may include clips coupled to the outer edge of the PED **102** using a compression fit. In alternative embodiments, the holder **2402** may be secured to the outer edge of the PED **102** using releasable clips, straps, or any other selectively locking mechanism. In certain embodiments, the length of the holder **2402** may be adjusted so that the holder **2402** fits securely around the outer edge of the PED **102**. In this manner, the holder **2402** may be adjusted to secure PEDs **102** having varied dimensions.

[0267] In certain embodiments, the rotational hub **2408** may include a rotational mechanism configured to allow the holder **2402** to rotate relative to a vertical support **2404**. The rotational mechanism may include a rotating grommet, a ratcheting swivel or pivot, a ball and socket mechanism, a temporary adhesive, a releasable latch, a clip, one or more buttons, a suction cup, and/or one or more straps allowing for rotational securement of the holder **2402** to the vertical support **2404**. In certain embodiments, the vertical support **2404** may be configured to support the PED **102** in a substantially upright and/or elevated position allowing for viewing of the display **104**. In some embodiments, the rotational hub **2408** may snap into certain specific rotational orientations (e.g., portrait orientation, as illustrated in FIG. **92**, and/or landscape orientation, as illustrated in FIG. **93**) and require rotational force to move to a different specific orientation. In alternative embodiments, the rotational hub **2408** may not snap into specific orientations but may allow for rotational articulation in any number of orientations. Further, in certain embodiments, the vertical support **2404** may be coupled to the holder **2402** via a non-rotatable connection including,

for example, a fixed and/or hinged mechanism.

[0268] The vertical support **2404** may be configured to allow for its length to be adjusted using a sliding track or similar adjustable mechanism. In certain embodiments, the length of the vertical support **2404** may be configured to be adjusted to one or more predetermined positions via a selective locking mechanism or the like. In other embodiments, the vertical support **2404** may have a fixed length.

[0269] The vertical support **2404** may be coupled to a base **2410** via a hinge **2412** allowing the vertical support **2404** to rotate relative to the base **2410** in one or more directions. In certain embodiments, by varying the orientation of the vertical support **2404** relative to the base **2410** via the hinge **2412**, a viewing angle of the PED **102** disposed in the holder **2402** may be adjusted.

[0270] In certain embodiments, the base **2410** may include one or more stabilizing supports **2414** configured to extend outward from the base **2410** on one or more sides and/or in one or more directions. In certain embodiments, the stabilizing supports **2414** may increase the surface area of the base **2410** on a working surface, thereby increasing the stability of the rotational case **2400** when in use. In some embodiments, the stabilizing supports **2414** may be slid along a track or similar mechanism into the base **2410** when not in use, as illustrated in FIG. **94**, and be slid out of the base **2410** to provide a more stable platform when in use, as illustrated in FIGS. **92-93** and FIG. **95**.

[0271] In some embodiments, the base **2410** may include one or more integrated interfaces **2406** configured to interface with the PED **102**. For example, as illustrated in FIGS. **92-93** and FIG. **95**, the base **2410** may include a keyboard **2406**. In other embodiments, the interfaces **2406** may include a touch pad, a speaker, or any other interface device capable of being integrated into the base **2410**.

[0272] When the PED **102** is not in use, the rotatable case **2400** may be reconfigured by a user into a stowage configuration, as illustrated in FIG. **94**. To reconfigure the rotatable case **2400** in a stowage configuration, the PED **102** may be articulated around the hinge **2412** so as to cover the display **104** of the PED **102** with the top surface of the base **2410**. In such a configuration, interfaces **2406** disposed on the top surface of the base **2410** may also be protected from external damage. In certain embodiments, reconfiguration of the case **2400** into a stowage configuration may require that the length of the vertical support **2404** be adjusted and/or a particular rotational orientation of the PED **102** be achieved. In some embodiments, the base **2410** may be secured to the PED **102** in the stowage configuration via a magnetic connection, one or more releasable clips, straps, and/or other locking mechanism allowing for the rotatable case **2400** to be selectively locked into a stowage configuration and selectively release from the stowage configuration.

[0273] FIGS. **96-99** illustrate a rotatable case **2500** for a PED **102** including an integrated keyboard **2502**. The rotatable case **2500** may include a holder **2504** configured to receive, secure, retain, and carry the PED **102**, and may include any combination of the various features and embodiments described in any of the cases and/or holders described herein. As illustrated, the holder **2504** may be configured to retain the PED **102** by mechanically securing the PED **102** using a compression fit mechanism or the like. In certain embodiments, the holder **2504** may retain the PED **102** by securing one or more corners of the PED **102**.

[0274] The holder **2504** may be coupled to a rotational mechanism **2506** which in turn may be coupled to a vertical support **2508** via an upper hinge **2510**. In certain embodiments, the rotational mechanism **2506** may be configured to allow the holder **2504** to rotate relative to the vertical support **2508**. The rotational mechanism **2506** may include a rotating grommet, a rotating hub, a ratcheting swivel or pivot, a ball and socket mechanism, a temporary adhesive, a releasable latch, a clip, one or more buttons, a suction cup, and/or one or more straps allowing for rotational securement of the holder **2504** to the vertical support **2508**. In certain embodiments, the vertical support **2508** may be configured to support the PED **102** in a substantially upright and/or elevated position allowing for viewing of the display **104**. In some embodiments, the rotational mechanism

2506 may snap into certain specific rotational orientations (e.g., portrait orientation, as illustrated in FIG. **98**, and/or landscape orientation, as illustrated in FIG. **96**, and require rotational force to move to a different specific orientation. In alternative embodiments, the rotational mechanism **2506** may not snap into specific orientations but may allow for rotational articulation in any number of orientations. Further, in certain embodiments, the vertical support **2508** may be coupled to the holder **2504** via a non-rotatable connection including, for example, a fixed and/or hinged mechanism, and may be connected directly or via the upper hinge **2510**.

[0275] The vertical support **2508** may be configured to allow for its length to be adjusted using a sliding track or similar adjustable mechanism. In certain embodiments, the length of the vertical support **2508** may be configured to be adjusted into one or more predetermined positions via a selective locking mechanism or the like. In other embodiments, the vertical support **2508** may have a fixed length.

[0276] The vertical support **2508** may be further coupled to a base **2514** via a lower hinge **2512** allowing the vertical support **2508** to rotate relative to the base **2514** in one or more directions. In certain embodiments, by varying the orientation of the vertical support **2508** relative to the base **2514** via the lower hinge **2512** and/or the holder **2504** via the upper hinge **2510**, a viewing angle of the PED **102** disposed in the holder **2404** may be adjusted.

[0277] As illustrated, the base **2514** may include one or more integrated interfaces **2502** configured to interface with the PED **102**. For example, as illustrated in FIGS. **96-98**, the base **2514** may include a keyboard. In other embodiments, the interfaces **2502** may include a touch pad, a speaker, or any other interface device capable of being integrated into the base **2514**. In certain embodiments, the interfaces **2502** may be configured to extend outward from the base **2514** on one or more sides and/or in one or more directions. In certain embodiments, by extending outwards, the interfaces **2502** may increase the effective surface area of the base **2514** on a working surface, thereby increasing the stability of the rotational case **2500** when in use. Further, by extending the interfaces **2502** outwards, the effective usable area of the interfaces **2502** may be increased. For example, when the interfaces **2502** include a keyboard, as illustrated in FIGS. **96-98**, extending the keyboard outwards may increase the size of the keyboard. In certain embodiments, the interfaces **2502** may be slid along a track or similar mechanism into the base **2514** when not in use, as illustrated in FIG. **99**, and be slid out of the base **2514** when in use, as illustrated in FIGS. **96-98**.

[0278] When the PED **102** is not in use, the rotatable case **2500** may be reconfigured by a user into a stowage configuration, as illustrated in FIG. **99**. To reconfigure the rotatable case **2500** in a stowage configuration, the PED **102** may be articulated around the upper hinge **2510** and the lower hinge **2512** so as to cover the display **104** of the PED **102** with the top surface of the base **2514**. In such a configuration, interfaces **2502** disposed on the top surface of the base **2514** may also be protected from external damage. In certain embodiments, reconfiguration of the case **2500** into a stowage configuration may require that the length of the vertical support **2508** be adjusted and/or a particular rotational orientation of the PED **102** be achieved. In some embodiments, the base **2514** may be secured to the PED **102** in the stowage configuration via a magnetic connection, one or more releasable clips, straps, and/or other locking mechanism allowing for the rotatable case **2500** to be selectively locked into a stowage configuration and selectively release from the stowage configuration.

[0279] FIGS. **100-102** illustrates a support **2600** for a PED **102**. As illustrated, the support **2600** may include a holder (not shown) configured to receive, secure, retain, and carry the PED **102**, and may include any combination of the various features and embodiments described in any of the cases and/or holders described herein. In certain embodiments, a rotatable kickstand **2602** may be coupled to the holder and configured to support the holder and PED **102** in an substantially upright and/or elevated position. In other embodiments, as illustrated, the support **2600** may include a rotatable kickstand **2602** coupled directly to the PED **102** one or more straps, buckles, clips, adhesives, and/or any other similar attachment feature.

[0280] In certain embodiments, the rotatable kickstand **2602** may incorporate similar features to the kickstand **1908** described above in reference to FIGS. **78-81**. In this manner, the viewing angle of the PED **102** may be adjusted by articulating the rotatable kickstand **2602** in various manners (e.g., changing the relative angle between the kickstand **2602** and the PED **102**, adjusting the length of the kickstand **2602**, and the like). Further, the viewing orientation of the PED **102** may be adjusted by rotating the relative position of the kickstand **2602** relative to the PED **102** using a rotational mechanism.

[0281] The support **2600** may further include a cover **2604** which in some embodiments, may include one or more integrated interfaces **2606** configured to interface with the PED **102**. For example, as illustrated in FIGS. **100-101**, the cover **2604** may include a keyboard. In other embodiments, the interfaces **2606** may include a touch pad, a speaker, or any other interface device capable of being integrated into the cover **2604**.

[0282] When the PED **102** is not in use, the support **2600** may be reconfigured by a user into a stowage configuration, as illustrated in FIG. **102**. To reconfigure the support **2600** in a stowage configuration, the cover **2604** may be secured over a side of the PED **102** so as to cover the display **104** of the PED **102** with the cover **2604** and protect it from external damage. In such a configuration, interfaces **2606** disposed on an inner surface of the cover **2604** may also be protected from external damage. In some embodiments, the cover **2604** may be secured to the PED **102** in the stowage configuration via a magnetic connection, one or more releasable clips, straps, and/or other locking mechanism allowing for the cover **2604** to be selectively locked into a stowage configuration and selectively release from the stowage configuration.

[0283] FIG. **103** illustrates an interaction between a support panel **2708** of a rotatable case **2700** and a securing panel **2702** via a selectively detachable rotational mechanism **2716**, **2718**. In certain embodiments, the rotatable case **2700** may include any combination of the various features and embodiments illustrated and described in reference to the rotatable case **800** of FIGS. **22-32**. As illustrated, the rotatable case **2700** may include a securing panel **2702** configured to receive, secure, retain, and carry a PED, and may include any combination of the various features and embodiments described in any of the cases and/or holders described herein.

[0284] The rotatable case **2700** may include a base **2706** with one or more support channels **2710** and a supporting panel **2708** comprising a lower portion **2712** and a pivot flat **2714**. The selectively detachable rotational mechanism **2716**, **2718** may include a rear portion **2716** coupled to the supporting panel **808** and a front portion **2718** coupled to the securing panel **2702**, which may include one or more access ports **2704**. In certain embodiments, the rear portion **2716** may be coupled to the pivot flat **2714** of the supporting panel **2708**.

[0285] According to various embodiments, the front portion **2718** of the selectively detachable rotational mechanism **2716**, **2718** may be mated with the rear portion **2716** of the selectively detachable rotational mechanism **2716**, **2718** in order to rotatably secure the securing panel **2702** to the pivot flap **2714** and/or supporting panel **2708**. In this manner, the securing panel **2702** may be free to rotate 360 degrees relative to the supporting panel **2708** about the selectively detachable rotational mechanism **2716**, **2718**.

[0286] In certain embodiments, the front portion **2718** and the rear portion **2716** of the grommet may be joined together during manufacturing or assembly and are not configured to be selectively separated by a user. Alternatively, a user may selectively separate the front portion **2718** from the rear portion **2716** in order to remove the securing panel **2702** from the pivot flap **2714**, as illustrated in FIG. **103**. In other embodiments, the front portion **2718** and the rear portion **2716** of the grommet are inseparable and the grommet may be selectively detachable from the pivot flap **2714** and/or the securing panel **2702**.

[0287] FIG. **104** illustrates an interaction of a selectively detachable rotational mechanism **2716**, **2718** and a securing panel **2702** of a rotatable case **2700** for a PED (not shown). Particularly, FIG. **104** illustrates the securing panel **2702** of FIG. **103** mounted on a surface **2720** which may, as

shown, be a back of a car seat. In alternative embodiments, the surface **2720** may be refrigerator door, a wall, a door, a desk, a window, and/or any other appropriate surface.

[0288] To mount the securing panel **2702** on the surface **2720**, the rear portion **2716** of the rotational grommet may be mounted to the surface **2720**, and the front portion **2718** may be secured to the rear portion **2716**, thereby rotationally securing the securing panel **2702** to the surface **2720**. In certain embodiments, the rear portion **2716** may be mounted to the surface **2720** using, for example, an adhesive, hook and loop mechanisms, buttons, one or more zippers, and/or clamps. Further, in some embodiments, the rear portion **2716** may be mounted to the surface **2720** using a mechanism allowing for rotation of the rear portion **2716** in one or more directions relative to the surface **2720** such as, for example, a hinge, a ball and socket joint, and the like. In certain embodiments, the mechanism allowing for rotation of the rear portion **2716** in one or more directions may allow a viewing angle of a PED disposed in the securing panel **2702** to be adjusted relative to the surface **2720**.

[0289] FIG. **105** illustrates a rotatable case **2800** including a user interface **2820**. As illustrated, the rotatable case **2800** may include a securing panel **2802** configured to receive, secure, retain, and carry the PED (not shown), and may include any combination of the various features and embodiments described in any of the cases and/or holders described herein. According to various embodiments, the rotatable case **2800** may include various access ports (such as **2804** and **2806**) to facilitate interfacing a PED disposed within the rotatable case **2800** with connector plugs, cables, headphones, speakers, and/or power adaptors. In certain embodiments, the rotatable case **2800** may include built-in cords to route power, connectivity, and/or headphone cables from a PED to an external device. Moreover, according to various embodiments, a battery may be built into a panel or pocket of the rotatable case **2800**.

[0290] In certain embodiments, the rotatable case **2800** may have the ability to rotate the securing panel **2802** with respect to a supporting panel **2808** and a base panel **2810**. Any of a wide variety of rotatable securing devices may be employed to rotatably secure securing panel **2802** to supporting panel **2808**. For example, bushings, flanged bushings, grommets, rivets, eyelets, plain bearings, bearings, and/or any combination thereof may be employed to rotatably secure the securing panel **2802** to the supporting panel **2808**. For example, as illustrated, a grommet **2812** may be configured to rotatably secure the securing panel **2802** to the supporting panel **2808**. In some embodiments, the grommet **2812** may comprise a ring that may allow a logo to show through the hole in the middle of grommet **2812**. In certain embodiments, one or more interchangeable accessories and/or inserts may “snap” into the hole in the middle of grommet **2812** including, for example, a logo insert, a proximity alarm or other loss prevention accessory, and the like.

[0291] The base panel **2812** may be configured with channels or groves **2814** to secure the bottom edge of securing panel **2802** when the securing panel **2802** is in an upright and/or elevated position. According to various alternative embodiments, in place of channels **2814** a frictional surface (e.g., rubberized surface or the like) or frictional contact patches may be utilized to secure the bottom edge of the securing panel **2802** in an upright and/or elevated position.

[0292] The supporting panel **2808** may be configured to provide a counterforce to the securing panel **2802** in order to support securing panel **2802** in an upright and/or elevated position. As illustrated, the supporting panel **2808** and the base panel **2810** may comprise a single panel folded or bent at **2816**. According to various embodiments, the relative proportions of the base panel **2810** and the supporting panel **2808** may be adapted for a particular application. Further, in certain embodiments, the rotatable case **2800** may be configured to support a PED at one or more angles relative to the base panel **2810** and in a plurality of orientations, including portrait and landscape.

[0293] In certain embodiments, the rotatable case **2800** may be configured in a stowage mode, wherein the base panel **2810** may be oriented so as to cover and protect a display of a PED secured in the securing panel **2802** from external damage. In some embodiments, the base panel **2810** may include one or more integrated interfaces **2820** including, as illustrated in FIG. **105**, a keyboard. In

other embodiments, the interfaces **2820** may include a touch pad, a speaker, or any other interface device capable of being integrated into the base **2810**. In certain embodiments, when the rotatable case **2800** is configured in a stowage mode, the securing panel **2802** and/or the PED may cover and protect the interfaces **2820** from external damage.

[0294] It will be understood by those having skill in the art that changes may be made to the details of the above-described embodiments without departing from the underlying principles presented herein. For example, the rotating and/or pivoting systems allowing for adjustable viewing orientation disclosed herein may be integrated into a stand, a mount, or any other type of accessory configured to receive a PED. In addition, any suitable combination of various embodiments, or the features thereof, is contemplated. Further, any methods disclosed herein may comprise one or more steps or actions for performing the described method. These method steps and/or actions may be interchanged with one another. In other words, unless a specific order of steps or actions is required for proper operation of the embodiment, the order and/or use of specific steps and/or actions may be modified.

[0295] Throughout this specification, any reference to “one embodiment,” “an embodiment,” or “the embodiment” means that a particular feature, structure, or characteristic described in connection with that embodiment is included in at least one embodiment. Thus, the quoted phrases, or variations thereof, as recited throughout this specification are not necessarily all referring to the same embodiment. Similarly, it should be appreciated that in the above description of embodiments, various features are sometimes grouped together in a single embodiment, figure, or description thereof for the purpose of streamlining the disclosure. This method of disclosure, however, is not to be interpreted as reflecting an intention that any claim require more features than those expressly recited in that claim. Rather, inventive aspects lie in a combination of fewer than all features of any single foregoing disclosed embodiment. It will be apparent to those having skill in the art that changes may be made to the details of the above-described embodiments without departing from the underlying principles set forth herein.

Claims

1. A case for a computer tablet, the computer tablet including a back side and a display side, comprising: a base panel configured to rest on a work surface; a support member pivotally coupled to the base panel and configured to support the computer tablet in an elevated position wherein the display side is accessible; a holder configured to receive the computer tablet and secure the computer tablet with the display side exposed; and consisting of one rotatable connector coupled to the support member and the holder to enable 360 degree rotational movement of the holder, wherein the base panel and support member are configurable to a close orientation wherein the holder faces the base panel and the display side is covered by the base panel and the support member extends along an exterior of the holder, wherein the base panel and support member are further configurable to an open position to support the holder and the computer tablet in an elevated position such that the holder and the computer tablet extend from the base panel.
2. The case of claim 1, wherein the base panel includes one or more channels.
3. The case of claim 1, wherein the base panel includes an interior surface with a frictional material.
4. The case of claim 1, wherein the support member includes a post.
5. The case of claim 1, wherein the holder is configured to secure the computer tablet in a frictional fit.
6. A case for a computer tablet, the computer tablet including a back side and a display side, comprising: a base panel configured to rest on a work surface; a support member pivotally coupled to the base panel and configured to support the computer tablet in an elevated position wherein the display side is accessible; a holder, including a front side and a back side, and configured to receive

the computer tablet in the front side of the holder and secure the computer tablet with the display side exposed; and consisting of one rotatable connector coupled to the support member and the back side of the holder to enable 360 degree rotational movement of the holder including rotational movement of the holder between portrait and landscape orientations, wherein the base panel and support member are configurable to a close orientation wherein the holder faces the base panel and the display side is covered by the base panel and the support member extends along the back side of the holder and such that the base panel and the support member are substantially parallel to one another and retain at least a majority of the computer tablet, wherein the base panel and support member are further configurable to an open position to support the holder and the computer tablet in an elevated position such that the holder and the computer tablet extend from the base panel.

7. The case of claim 6, wherein the base panel includes one or more channels.

8. The case of claim 6, wherein the base panel includes an interior surface with a frictional material.

9. The case of claim 6, wherein the support member includes a post.

10. The case of claim 6, wherein the holder is configured to secure the computer tablet in a frictional fit.
